

CONNECTICUT FAMILY VIOLENCE 2023 HOMICIDE REPORT



Department of Emergency Services and Public Protection

Crimes Analysis Unit, Division of State Police

Ronnell Higgins, Commissioner



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Family Violence Homicide Summary 2023

- There were 24 family violence homicide incidents in 2023 resulting in 34 deaths: 25 victims, seven offender suicides, one offender shot by victim relative, one offender involved in a fatal motor vehicle accident.
- Family violence homicide victims accounted for 19 percent of total homicide victims during 2023.
- Females accounted for 20 victims (80%); male victims totaled five (20%).
- Males were more often the offender in family violence homicides, 23 of 24 incidents (96%).
- Eighteen homicide victims were in an intimate relationship with the offender (72%).
- Firearms were the most used weapon to commit murder, utilized in 11 incidents (46%).
- Victims ranged in age from 2 years old (daughter) to 83 years old (grandmother).
- Offenders ranged in age from 18 years old (grandson) to 63 years old (boyfriend).
- December had the highest number of family violence homicide incidents during 2023 with four.
- Monday had the highest count of family violence homicide incidents, 10 (42%).
- Six (25%) family violence homicide incidents occurred between 11:00am – 1:00pm.
- Ten family violence homicide incidents occurred in the victim's residence (43%).
- A family violence homicide occurred in 17 Connecticut municipalities during 2023. Hartford had the highest incident count with three.
- In 21 family violence homicide incidents (88%) there were no court orders of protection, either active or expired.
- A child under 18 years of age was involved in two family violence homicide incidents (8).
- Eighteen of the homicide victims (72%) and 12 of the homicide offenders (50%) had not been involved in a previous reported family violence arrest incident in the State of Connecticut.

2023 State of Connecticut Family Violence Homicides

	<u>Date</u>	<u>Department</u>	<u>Weapon</u>	<u>Victim</u>		<u>Relationship</u>	<u>Offender</u>	
				<u>Age</u>	<u>Sex</u>		<u>Age</u>	<u>Sex</u>
1.	1/31/23	* Bethel	Firearm	52	F	Spouse	58	M
2.	2/14/23	* CSP-Brooklyn	Firearm	33	F	Child in common	32	M
3.	2/14/23	* CSP-Brooklyn	Firearm	3	M	Other relative <i>not</i> residing in home: Son	32	M
4.	2/20/23	Bridgeport	Hands/Fist/Feet	68	M	Other relative residing in home: Grandfather	23	M
5.	3/6/23	Bridgeport	Firearm	23	F	Child in common	41	M
6.	3/7/23	* Waterbury	Firearm	45	F	Spouse	44	M
7.	3/19/23	Stamford	Hands/Fist/Feet	21	M	Dating	21	M
8.	4/10/23	Waterbury	Other Dangerous: Wooden Post Hands/Fist/Feet	67	M	Other relative <i>not</i> residing in home: Father	42	M
9.	4/16/23	Hartford	Knife	57	F	Dating	52	M
10.	5/10/23	CSP-Chaplin	Hands/Fist/Feet	38	F	Spouse	38	M
11.	6/5/23	New Milford	Hands/Fist/Feet	56	F	Other relative residing in home: Mother	34	M
12.	6/17/23	East Hartford	Knife	51	F	Spouse	57	M
13.	7/17/23	Vernon	Hands/Fist/Feet	22	F	Child in common	23	M
14.	7/17/23	Hartford	Firearm	64	F	Dating	63	M
15.	7/24/23	* Hartford	Firearm	24	F	Dating	35	M
16.	8/19/23	New Haven	Firearm	54	F	Child in common	54	M
17.	9/11/23	CSP-Cromwell	Hands/Fist/Feet	2	F	Other relative residing in home: Daughter	24	F
18.	10/14/23	CSP-New Hartford	Firearm	48	F	Spouse	50	M
19.	10/27/23	* Danbury	Knife	21	F	Dating	28	M
20.	10/28/23	CSP-Essex	Knife	36	M	Other relative <i>not</i> residing in home: Father	18	M
21.	11/20/23	* Danbury	Knife	21	F	Child in common	29	M
22.	12/1/23	New Britain	Firearm	27	F	Dating	46	M
23.	12/14/23	* New Haven	Firearm	52	F	Spouse	62	M
24.	12/25/23	Bristol	Knife Hands/Fist/Feet	83	F	Other relative residing in home:	38	M
25.	12/30/23	New Britain	Firearm	44	F	Dating	44	M

* Murder-Suicide

CSP=Connecticut State Police

Note: The above list includes incidents submitted to the Department of Emergency Services and Public Protection prior to May 8, 2024.

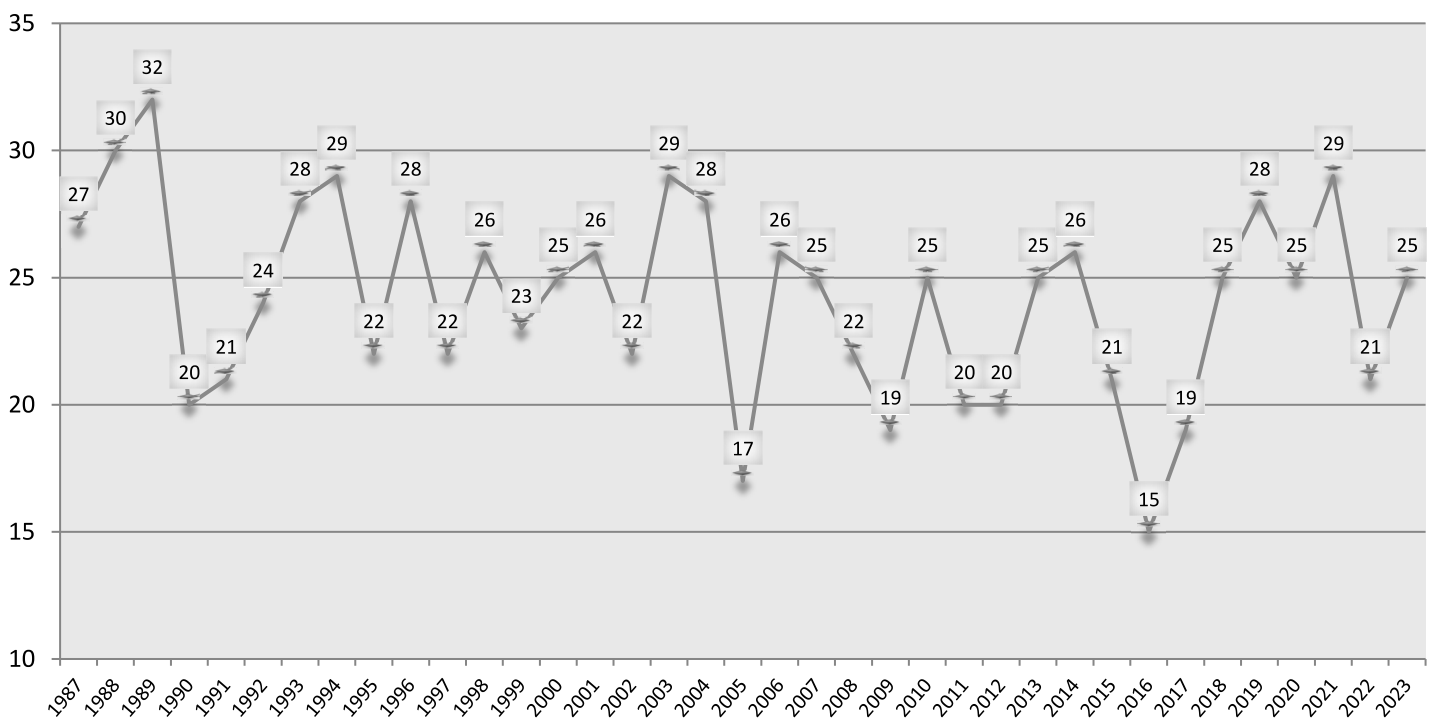
Family Violence Homicides 2023

Summaries of family violence homicides occurring in Connecticut during calendar year 2023 are presented in this report. Incidents are included in this report if a family or household member as defined in Connecticut General Statute 46b-38a (2) was arrested for the crime as of May 8, 2024. "Family or household member" means any of the following persons, regardless of the age of such person: (A) Spouses or former spouses; (B) parents or their children; (C) persons related by blood or marriage; (D) persons other than those persons described in subparagraph (C) of this subdivision presently residing together or who have resided together; (E) persons who have a child in common regardless of whether they are or have been married or have lived together at any time; and (F) persons in, or who have recently been in, a dating relationship. These homicides have been matched against offenses reported via National Incident Based Reporting System reports. Any homicide circumstance information provided is derived from newspaper accounts or other publicly available sources.

OVERVIEW

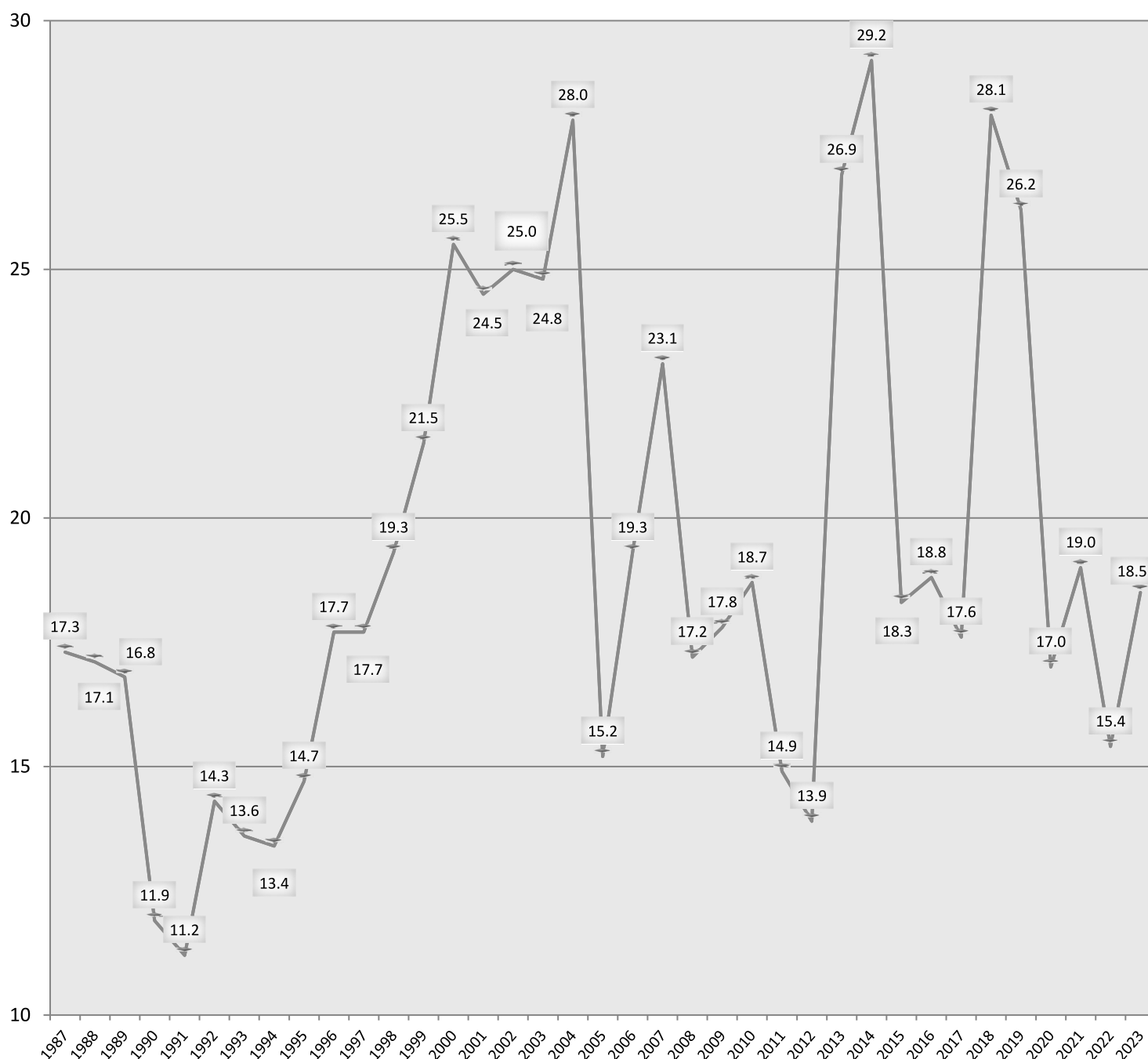
In 2023 there were 24 family violence homicide incidents involving 25 victims. The total number of deaths from these incidents was 34 including seven offender suicides, one offender shot by victim relative, and one offender involved in a fatal motor vehicle accident. The first full calendar year of collected family violence data was 1987. The number of family violence homicide victims ranged from a low of 15 in 2016 to a high of 32 in 1989. Between 1987 and 2023, there have been 895 recorded family violence homicide victims, an average of 24 per calendar year. The numbers listed below may be different from previously published reports. In some cases, the offenders were arrested after publication of the data.

Family Violence Homicide Victims 1987 - 2023



Family violence homicide victims accounted for 18.5 percent of total homicide victims during 2023. This percent ranged from a low of 11.2 in 1991 to a high of 29.2 percent in 2014. For the time span of 1987 to 2023 family violence homicide victims accounted for 18.2 percent of homicide victims in Connecticut.

Family Violence Homicide Victims as Percent of Total Homicide Victims 1987 - 2023



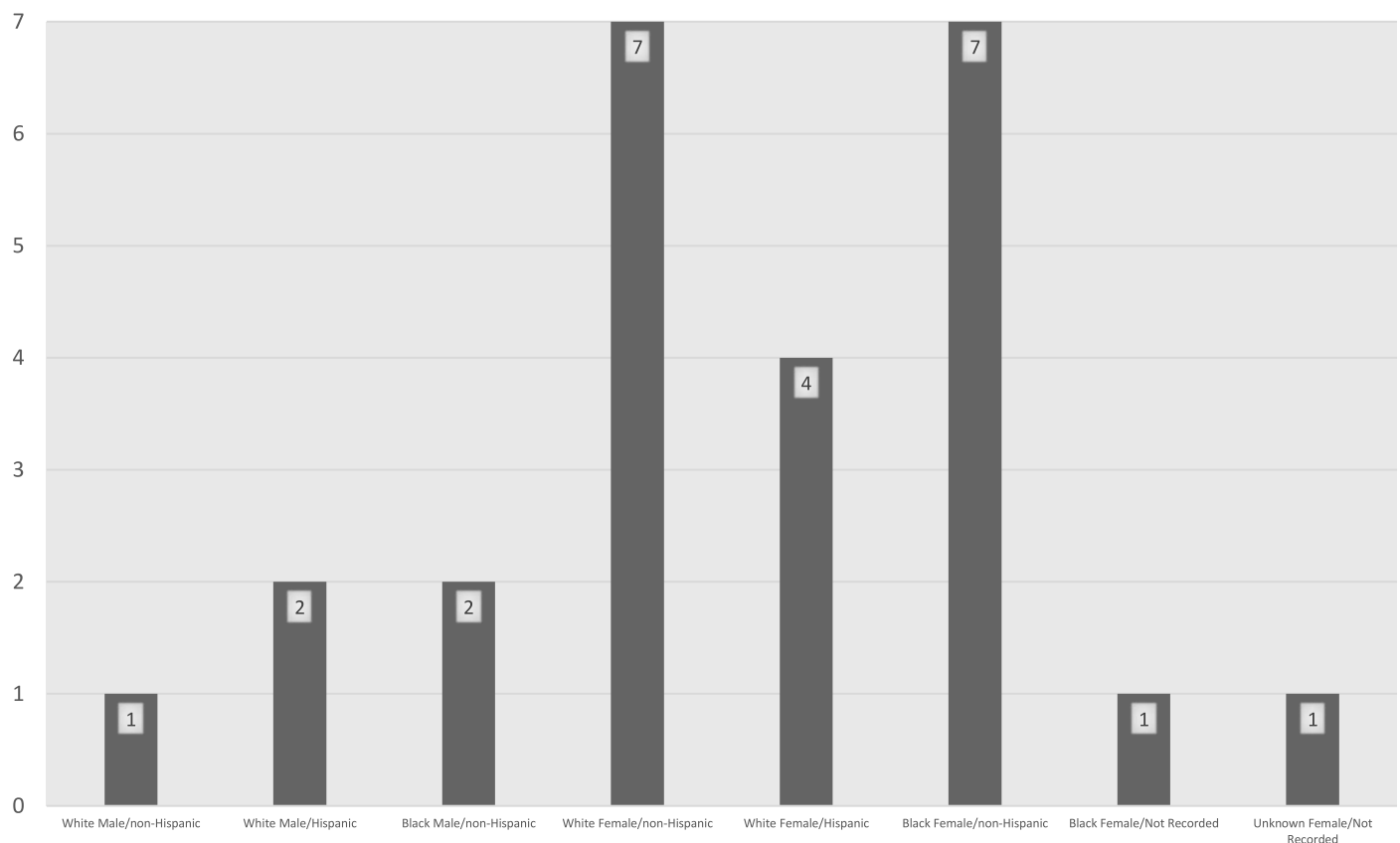
Victim Gender and Race/Ethnicity

In 2023 females were more often the victim of a family homicide than males. Of the 25 victims, 20 (80%) were female and five (20%) were male. Fourteen (56%) of the 2023 homicide victims were White, ten (40%) were Black, one was Unknown race (4%). White/non-Hispanic females and Black/non-Hispanic females had the highest victim total, each with seven (28%).

Victims by Gender and Race/Ethnicity

Race/Ethnicity	Male		Female		Total	
	# Victims	% Victims	# Victims	% Victims	# Victims	% Victims
White/non-Hispanic	1	4%	7	28%	8	32%
White/Hispanic	2	8%	4	16%	6	24%
White/Not Recorded	-	-	-	-	-	-
Total White	3	12%	11	44%	14	56%
Black/non-Hispanic	2	8%	7	28%	9	36%
Black/Hispanic	-	-	-	-	-	-
Black/Not Recorded	-	-	1	4%	1	4%
Total Black	2	8%	8	32%	10	40%
Unknown/non-Hispanic	-	-	-	-	-	-
Unknown/Hispanic	-	-	-	-	-	-
Unknown/Not Recorded	-	-	1	4%	1	4%
Total Unknown	-	-	1	4%	1	4%
Total	5	20%	20	80%	25	100%

Victims Gender and Race/Ethnicity



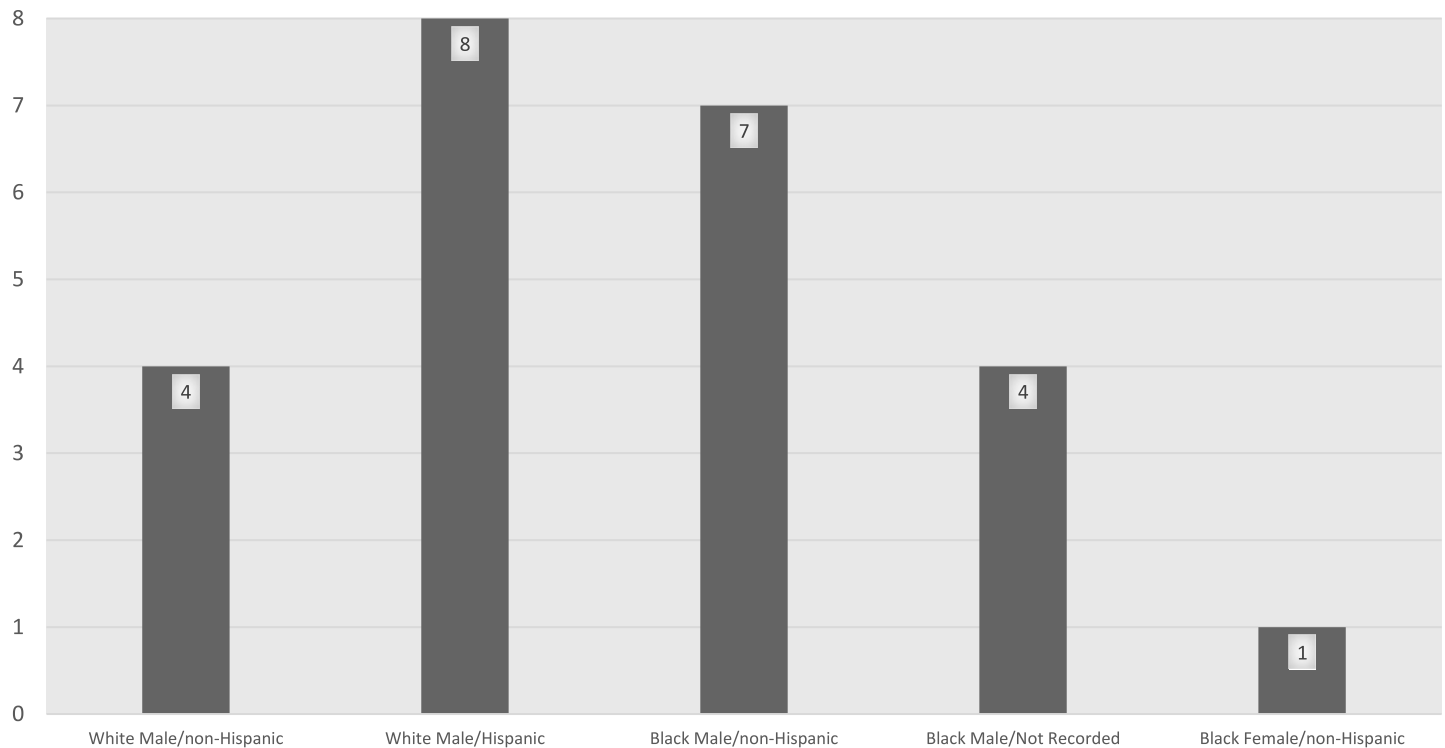
Offender Gender and Race/Ethnicity

Males were more often the offender in family violence homicide incidents. Twenty-three offenders were male (96%) while one was female (4%). Twelve (50%) of the 2023 homicide offenders were White, 12 (50%) were Black. White/Hispanic males accounted for the highest offender total, eight offenders (33%). White/Hispanic males accounted for the highest offender total, eight offenders (33%).

Offenders by Gender and Race/Ethnicity

Race/Ethnicity	Male		Female		Total	
	# Offenders	% Offenders	# Offenders	% Offenders	# Offenders	% Offenders
White/non-Hispanic	4	17%	-	-	4	17%
White/Hispanic	8	33%	-	-	8	33%
White/Not Recorded	-	-	-	-	-	-
Total White	12	50%	-	-	12	50%
Black/non-Hispanic	7	29%	1	4%	8	33%
Black/Hispanic	-	-	-	-	-	-
Black/Not Recorded	4	17%	-	-	4	17%
Total Black	11	46%	1	4%	12	50%
Total	23	96%	1	4%	24	100%

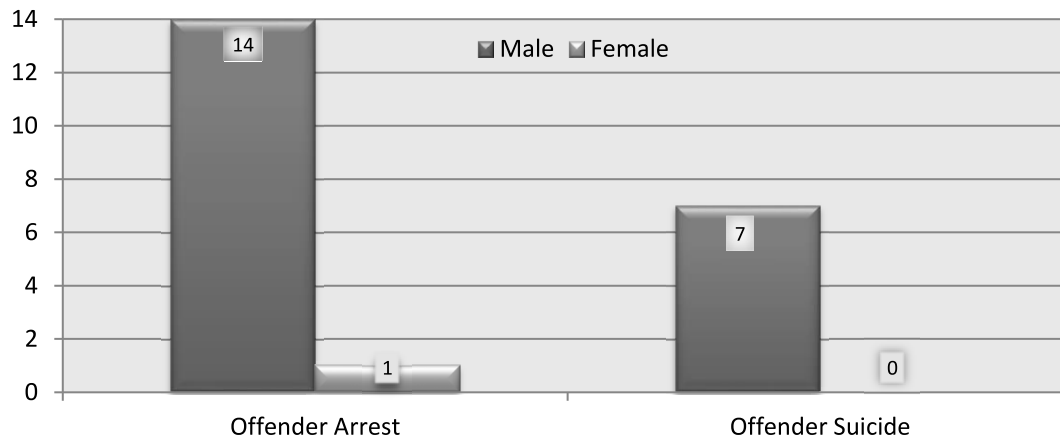
Offenders Gender Race/Ethnicity



Offender Arrests-Suicides

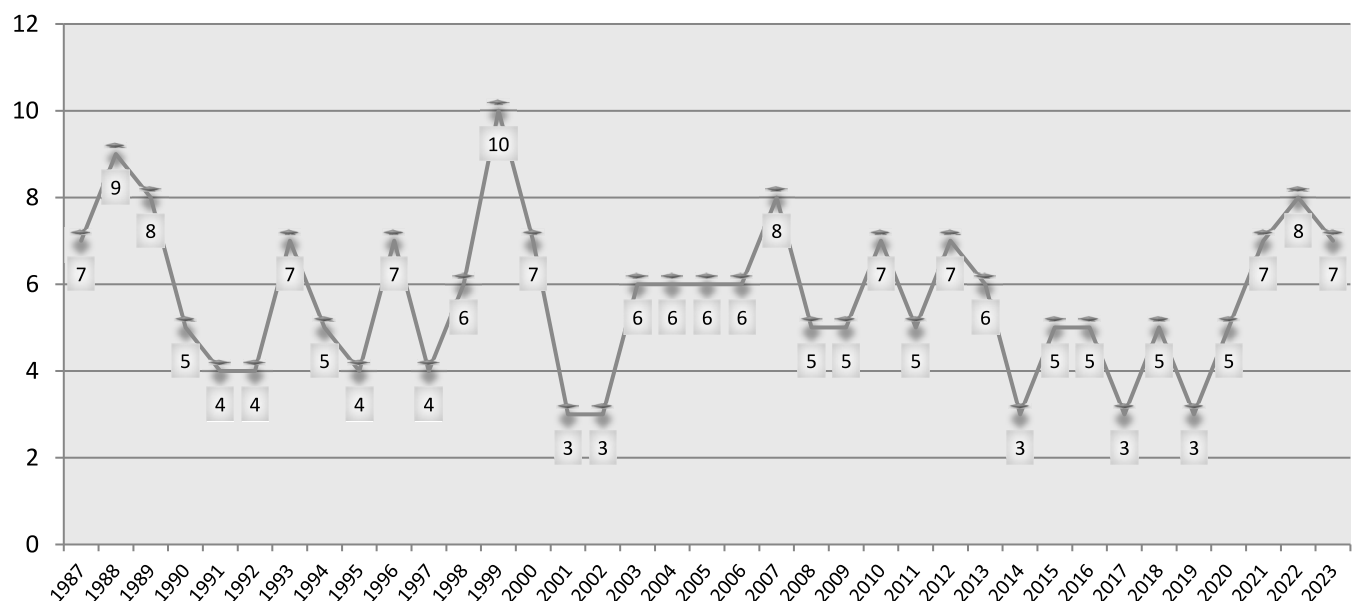
A total of 15 offenders were arrested (63%). Seven offenders committed suicide (29%). One offender died in a fatal motor vehicle accident (4%). One offender was shot and killed by a family member protecting the homicide victim from the offender (4%). One murder-suicide incident involved two victims. All seven murder-suicide incidents involved participants in an intimate relationship, all seven intimate victims were female. All seven of the offenders of murder-suicide incidents were male. Five of the seven murder-suicide incidents involved a firearm; two incidents involved a knife.

Offender Arrests-Suicides



Between 1987 and 2023, 211 suspected offenders committed suicide, an average of six per calendar year. The number of offender suicides ranged from a high of 10 in 1999 to a low of three in 2001, 2002, 2014, 2017 and 2019.

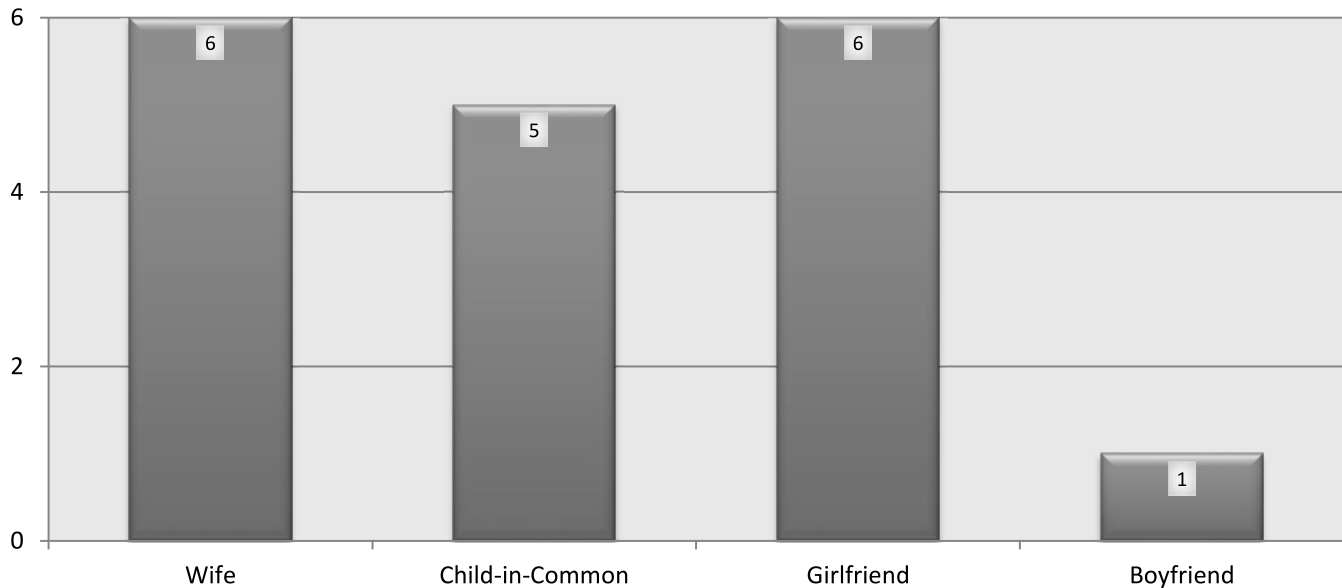
Offender Suicides 1987-2023



Intimate/non-Intimate Relationship

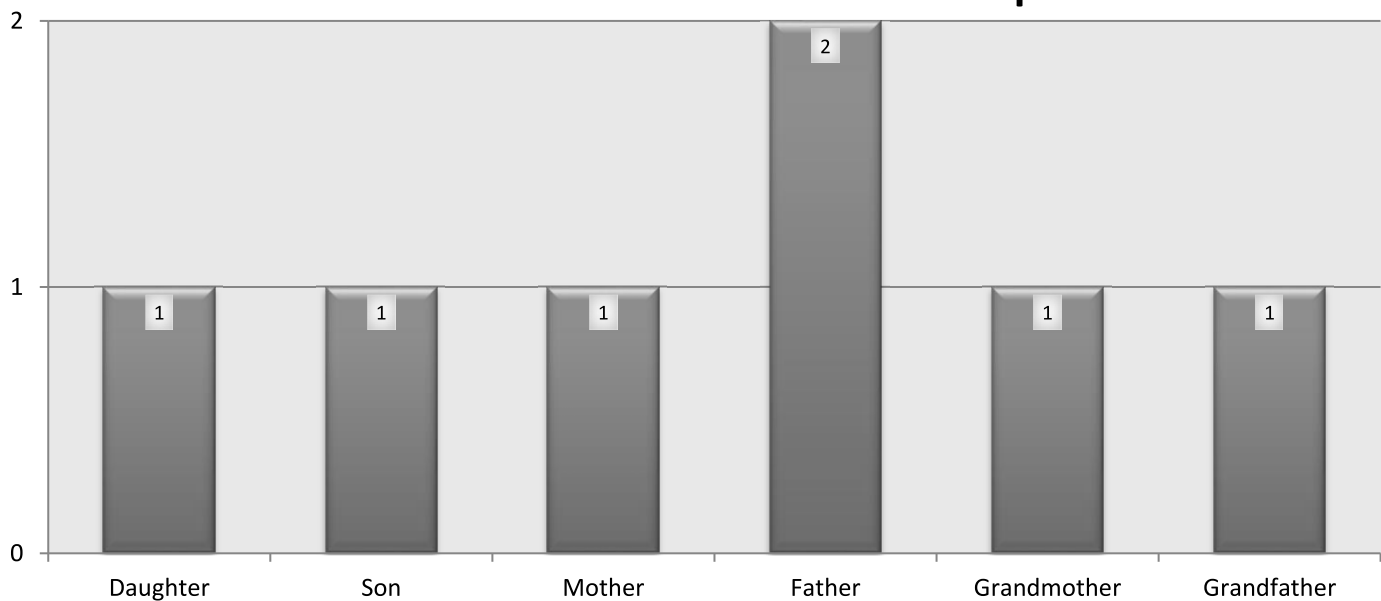
Eighteen homicide victims were in an intimate relationship with the offender (72%). The 18 intimate victims included six wives, five child-in-commons, six girlfriends, and one boyfriend. Overall, 17 intimate victims were female, and one was male.

Victims Intimate Relationship



Seven homicide victims were in a non-intimate relationship with the offender (28%). The seven non-intimate victims included one daughter, one son, one mother, two fathers, one grandmother, and one grandfather. Overall, four victims were male and three were female.

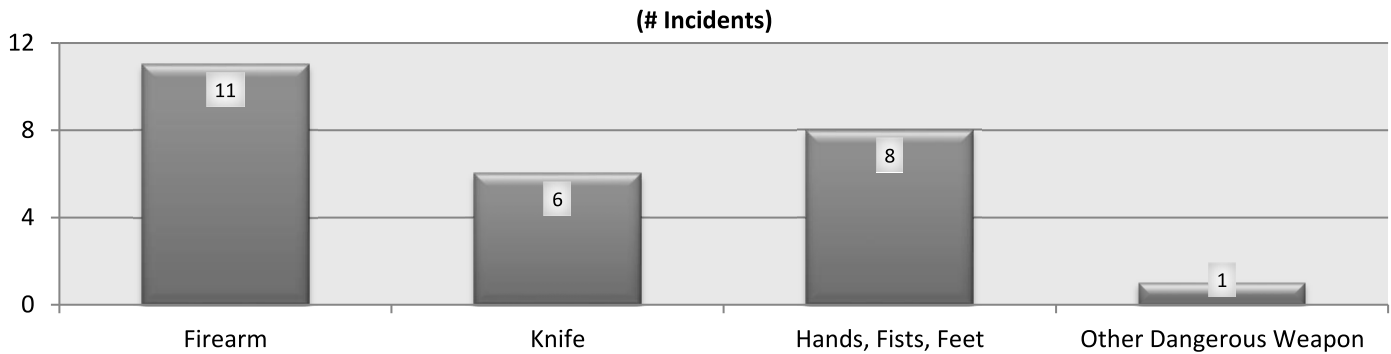
Victims non-Intimate Relationship



Weapons

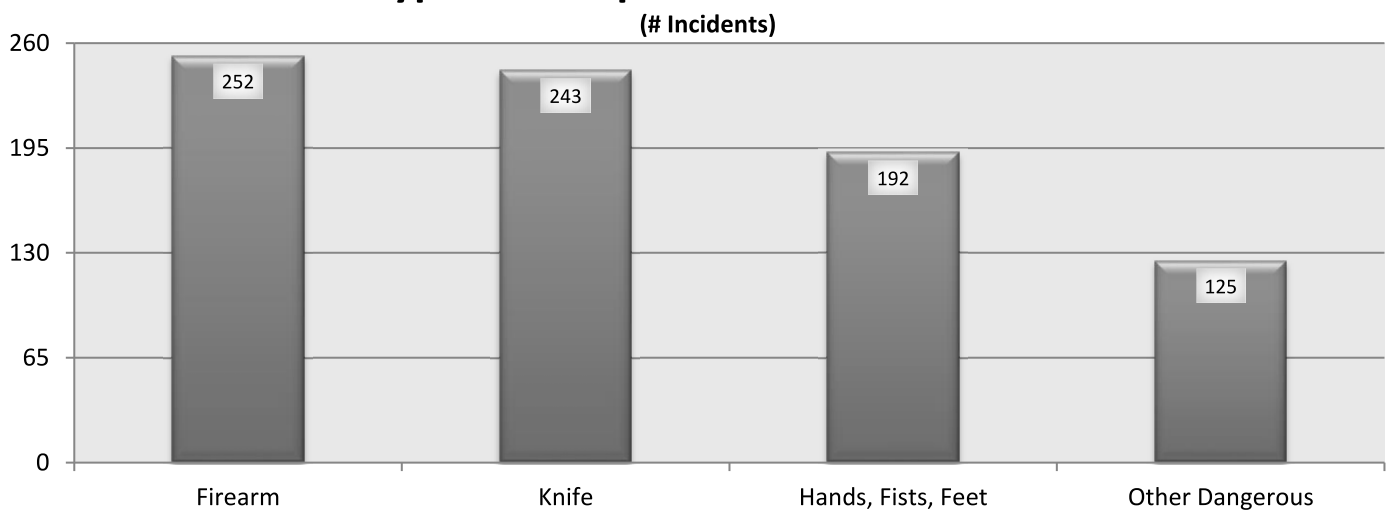
A weapon is defined as any object, instrument, device, or part of the anatomy used in an attack. If more than one weapon was reported being used, all weapons are counted in the following chart. In the 24 family violence homicide incidents, firearms were the most used weapon, 11 incidents (46%). Other weapons included knives, six incidents (25%); hands, fists, feet, eight incidents (33%); other dangerous weapons, one incident (4%). Other dangerous weapon used was a wooden post.

Type of Weapon Used - 2023



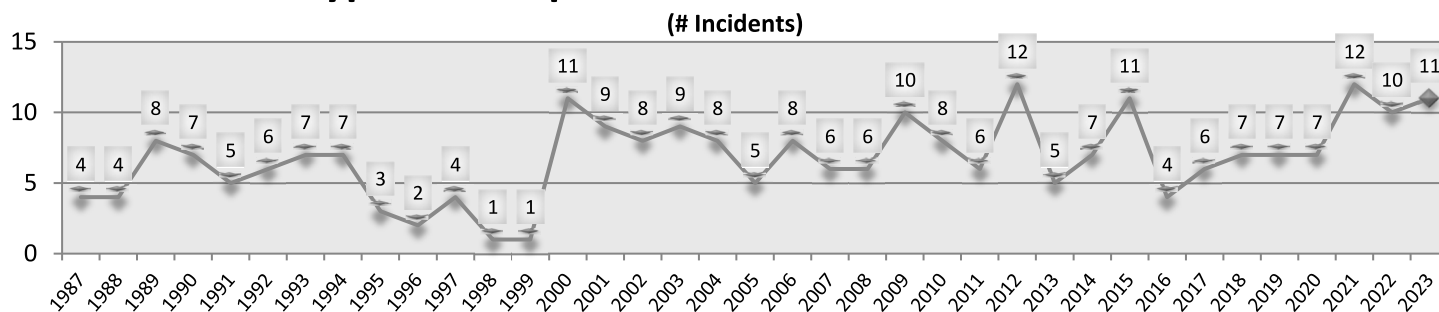
Prior to calendar year 2000, the details of family violence homicides that resulted in no arrest due to the suicide of the offender were not captured. The following chart illustrates the total number of family violence incidents by weapon used where incident details were captured. If more than one weapon was reported being used, all weapons are counted in the graph below.

Type of Weapon Used 1987 - 2023

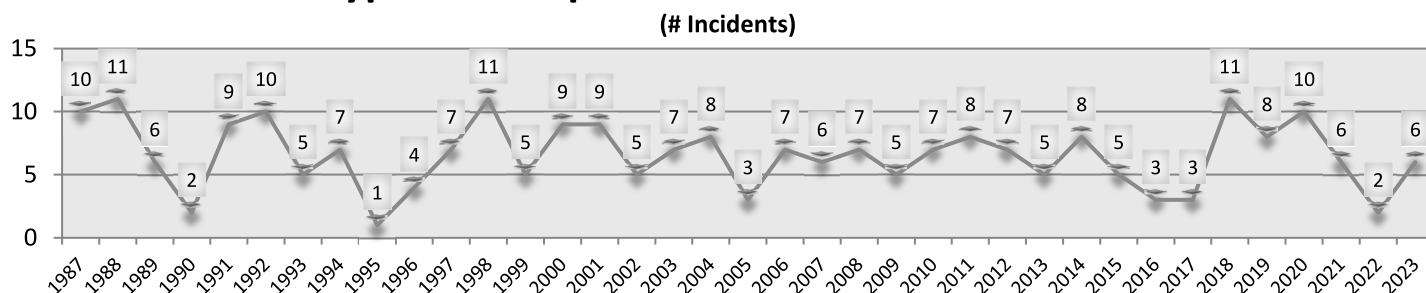


The following charts illustrate the total number of family violence incidents by weapon where incident details were captured. If more than one weapon was reported being used, all weapons are counted in the charts below.

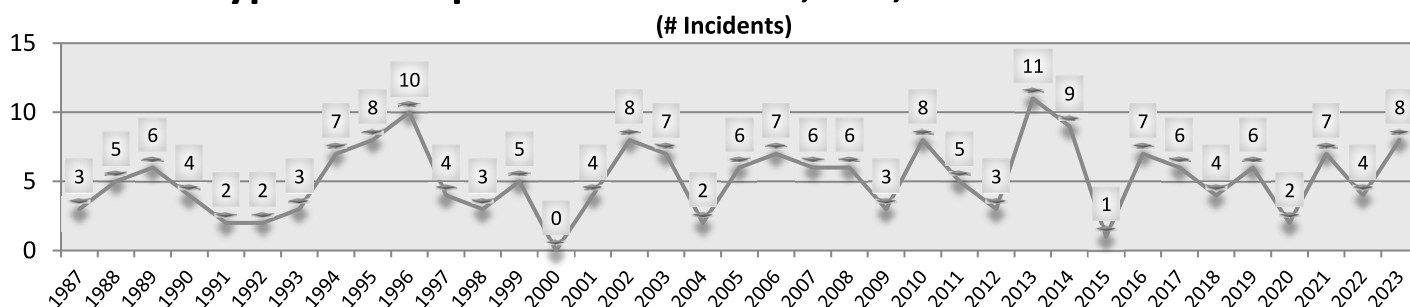
Type of Weapon Used - Firearm 1987 - 2023



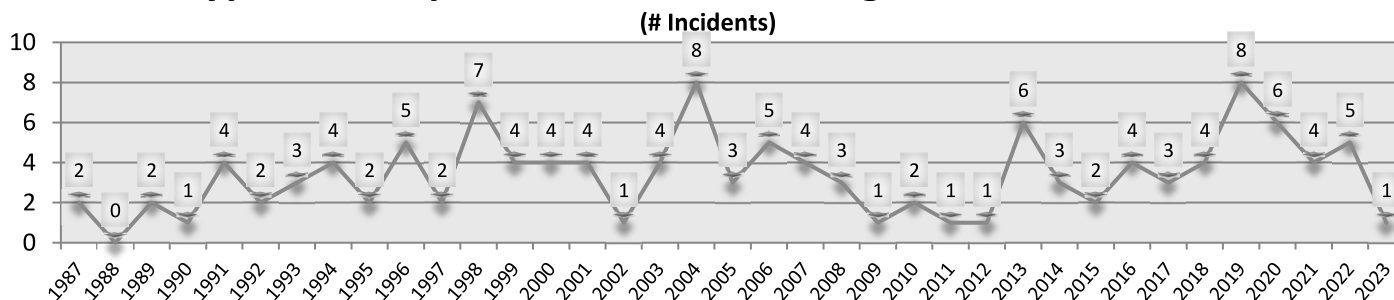
Type of Weapon Used - Knife 1987 - 2023



Type of Weapon Used - Hands, Fist, Feet 1987 - 2023



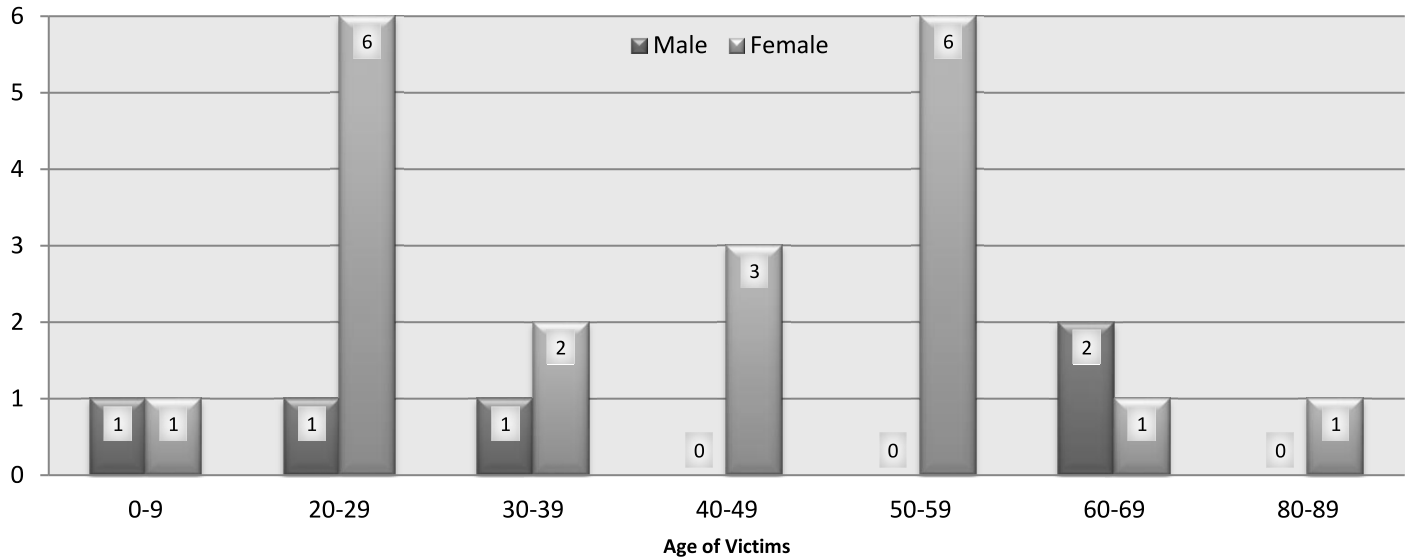
Type of Weapon Used - Other Dangerous 1987 - 2023



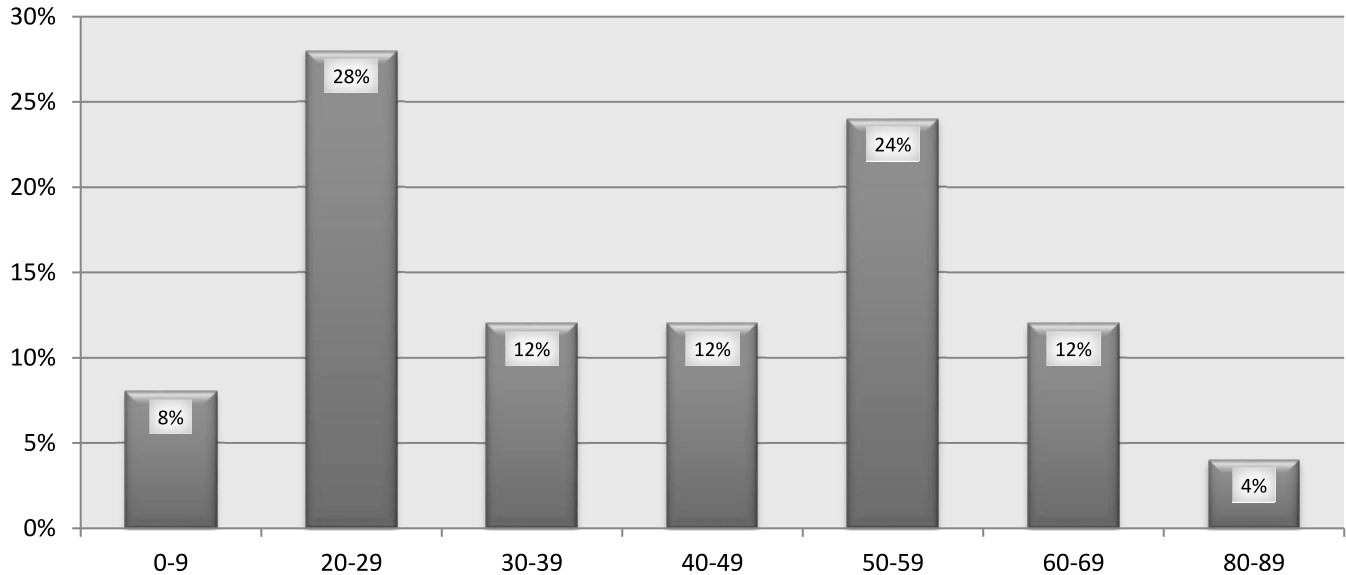
Age & Gender of Victims

In 2023 the youngest victim of a domestic homicide was a 2-year-old female (daughter). The oldest victim was an 83-year-old female (grandmother). The highest number of victims were in the 20 to 29 age group with seven. The average age of female victims was 41 years old; the average age of male victims was 39 years old.

Age & Gender of Victims



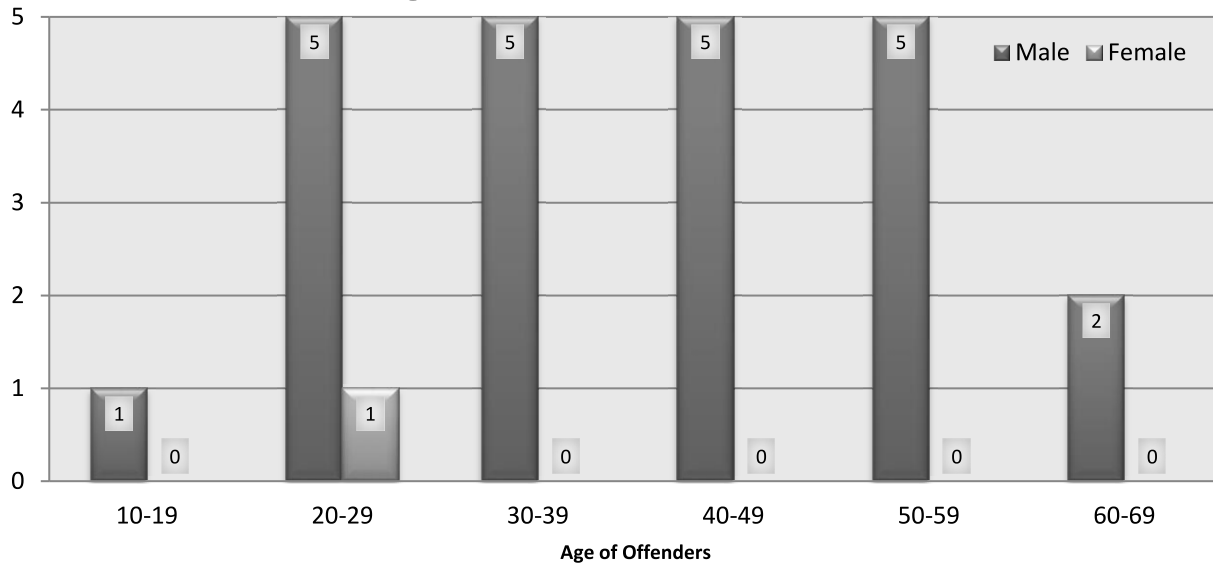
Age of Victims



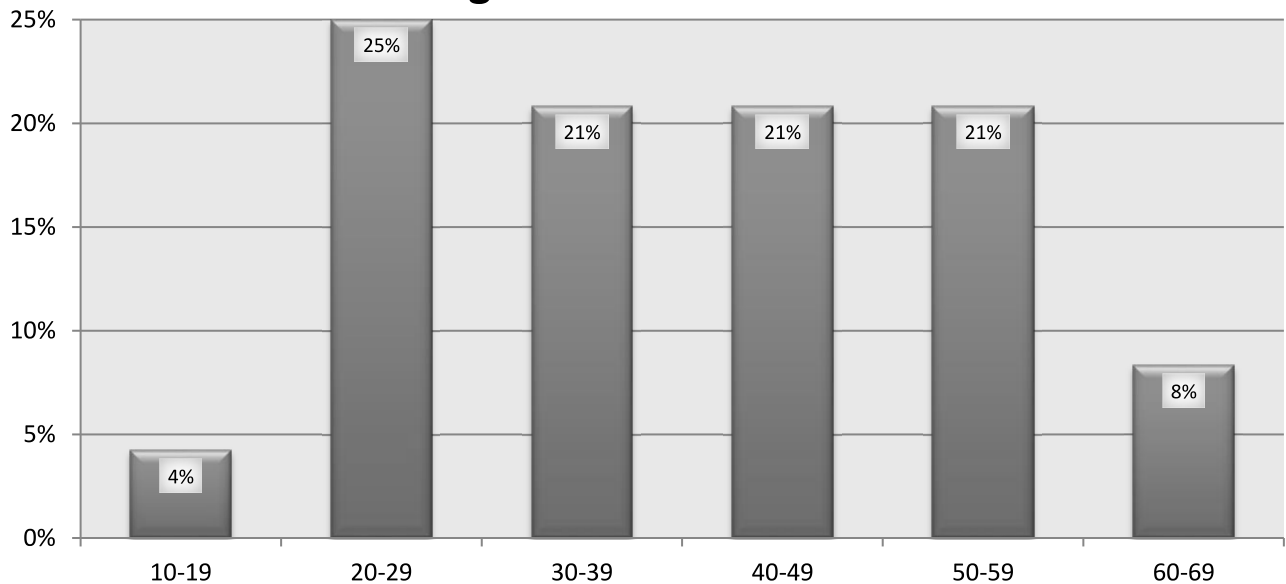
Age & Gender of Offenders

The youngest offender to commit a domestic homicide during 2023 was an 18-year-old male (grandson). The oldest offender was a 63-year-old male (boyfriend). The highest number of offenders was in the 20 to 29 age group, six (25%). The average age of male offenders was 41 years old; the age of the female offender was 24.

Age & Gender of Offenders

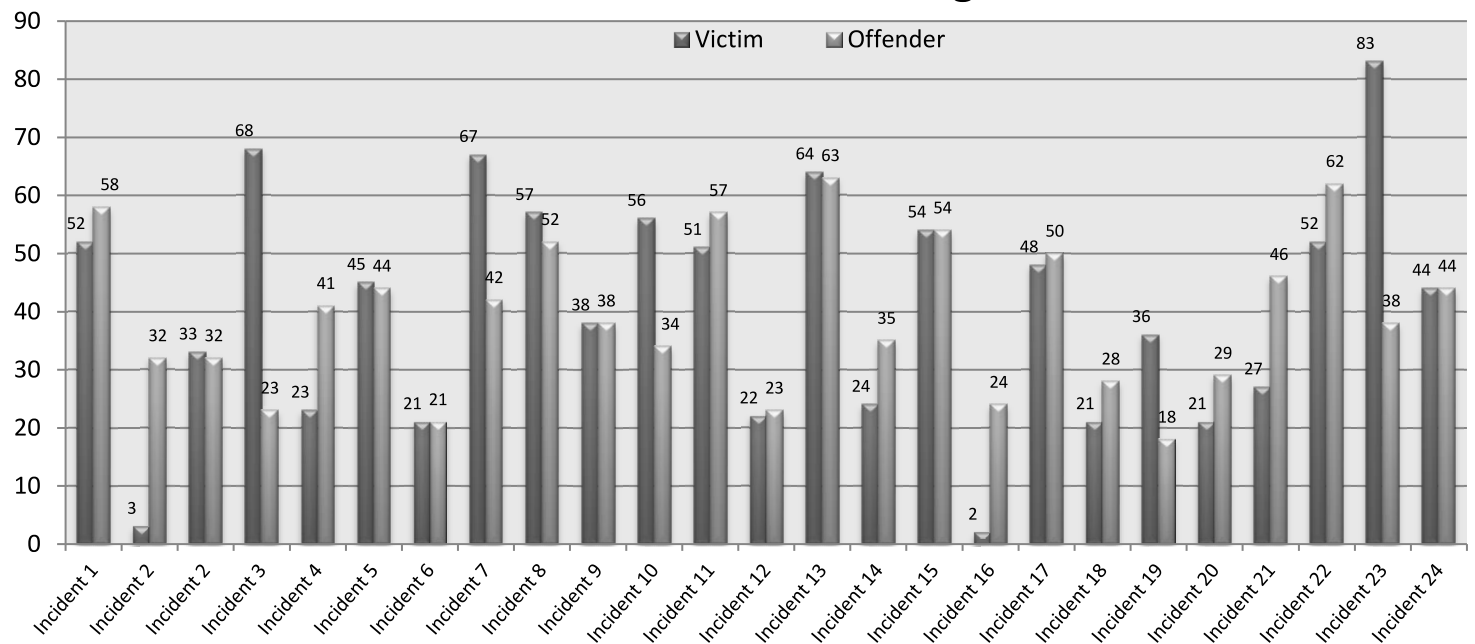


Age of Offenders



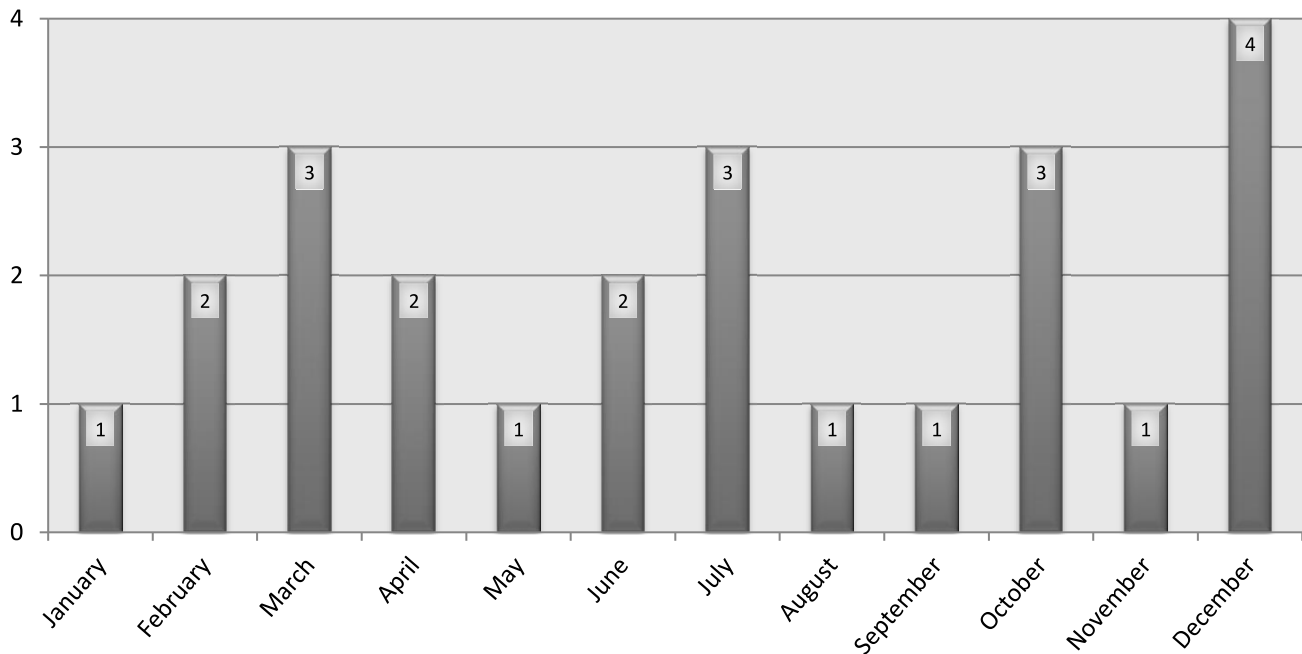
Twelve of the 25 family violence homicide victims were younger than the offender, (48%). Nine victims (36%) were older than the offender. Four victims were the same age as the offender (16%). Overall, the age difference ranged from 29 years younger to 45 years older.

Victim - Offender Age



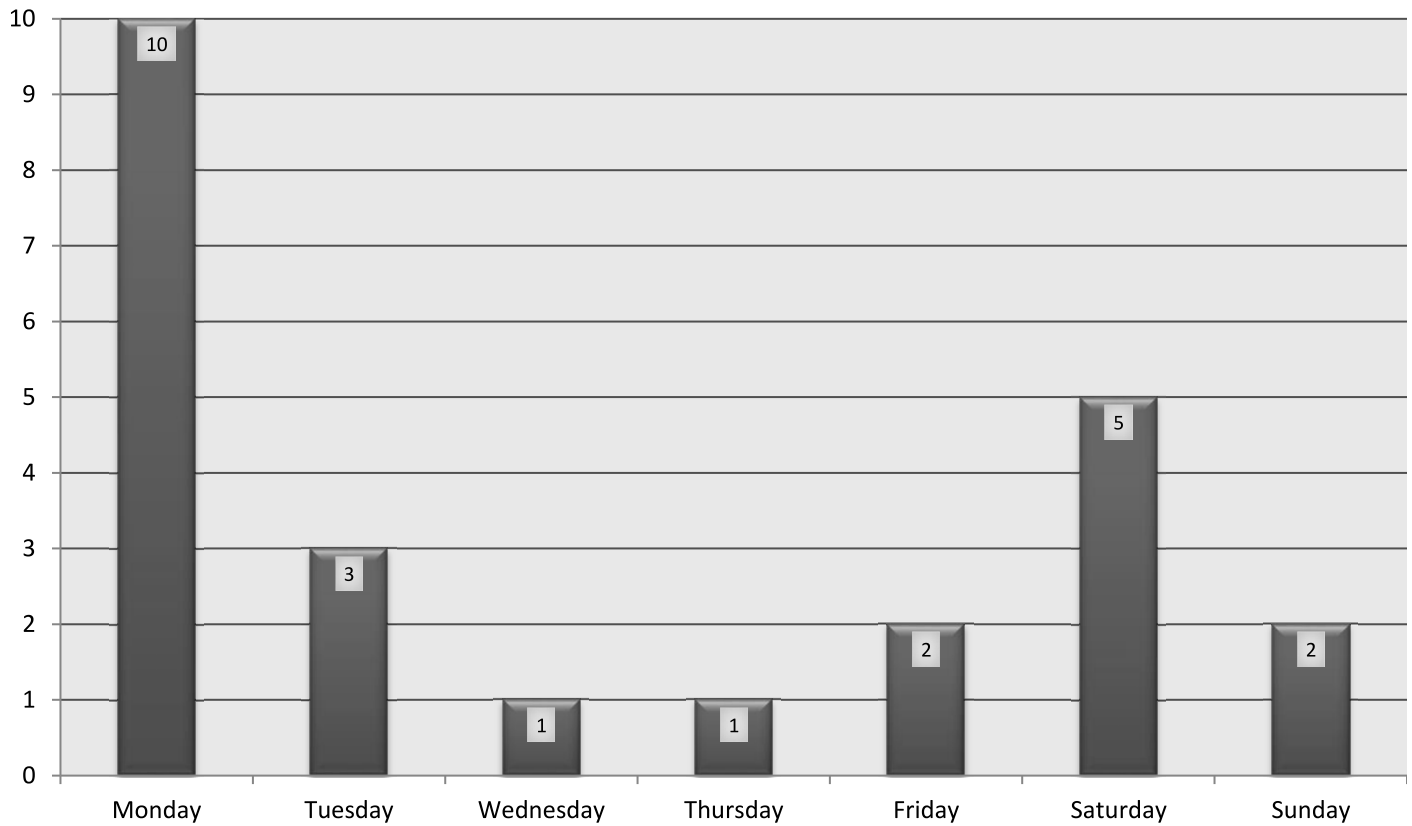
Month of Homicide

Homicide Incidents - Month of Year



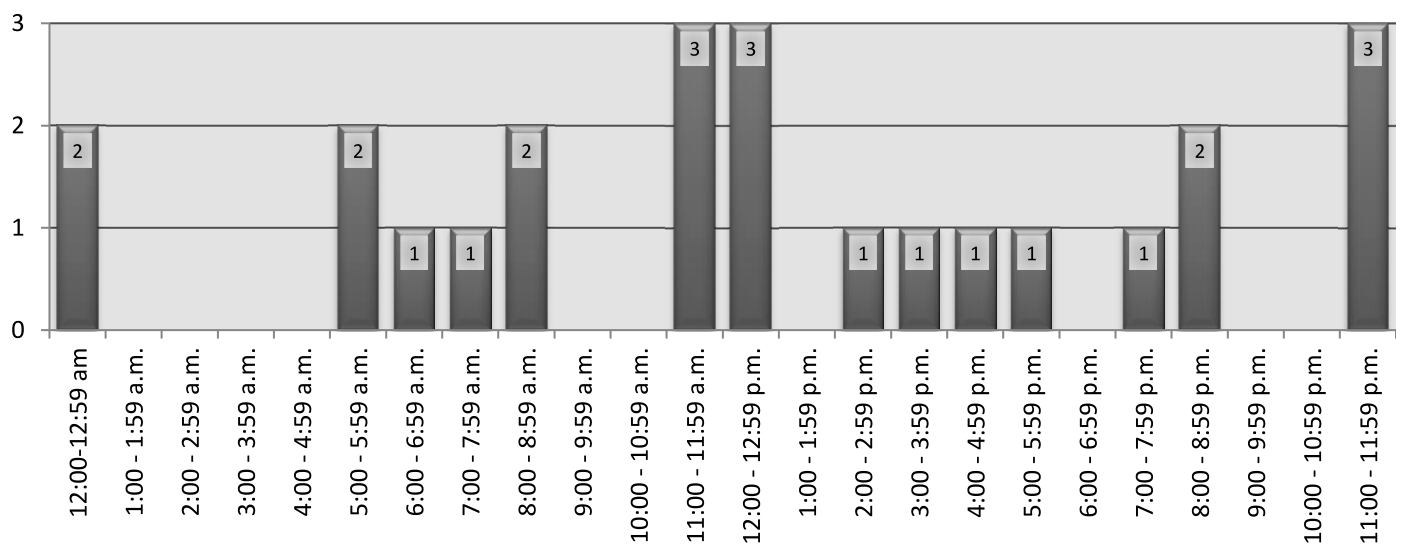
Homicide Incidents Day of Week

Homicide Incidents - Day of Week



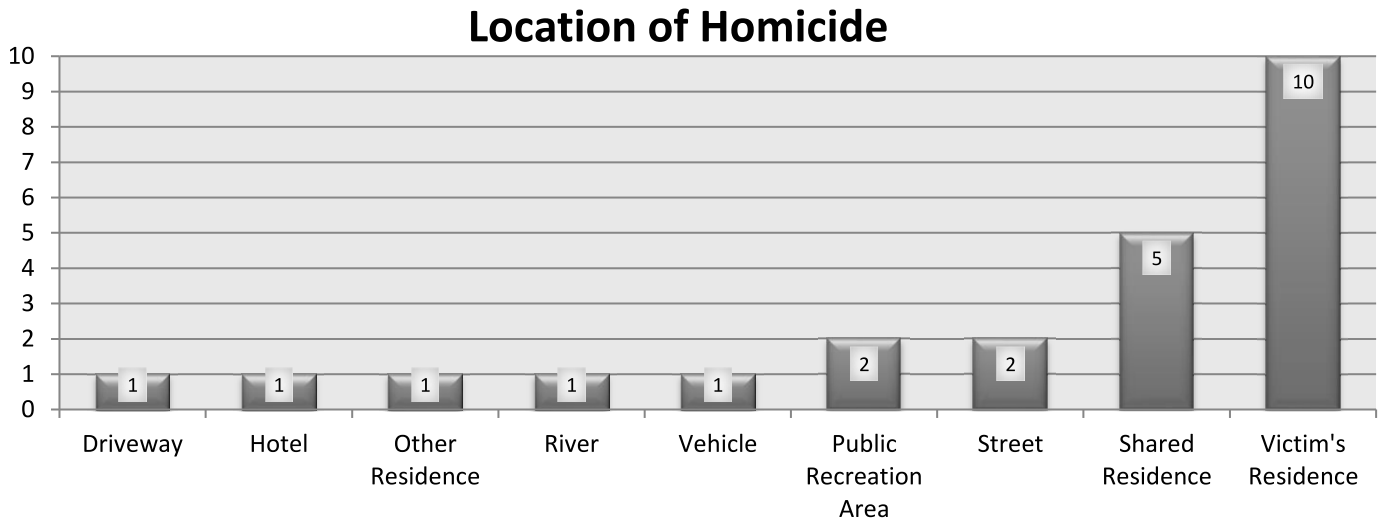
Homicide Incidents Time of Day

Homicide Incidents - Time of Day



Location of Homicide

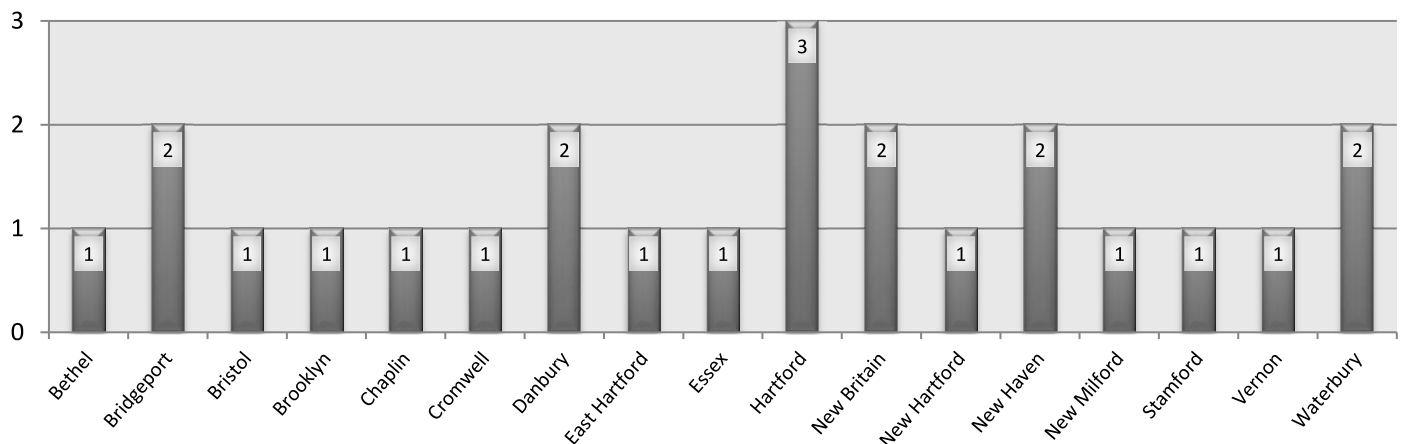
Ten of the 24 family violence homicide incidents occurred in the victim's residence (42%).



Geographic Distribution

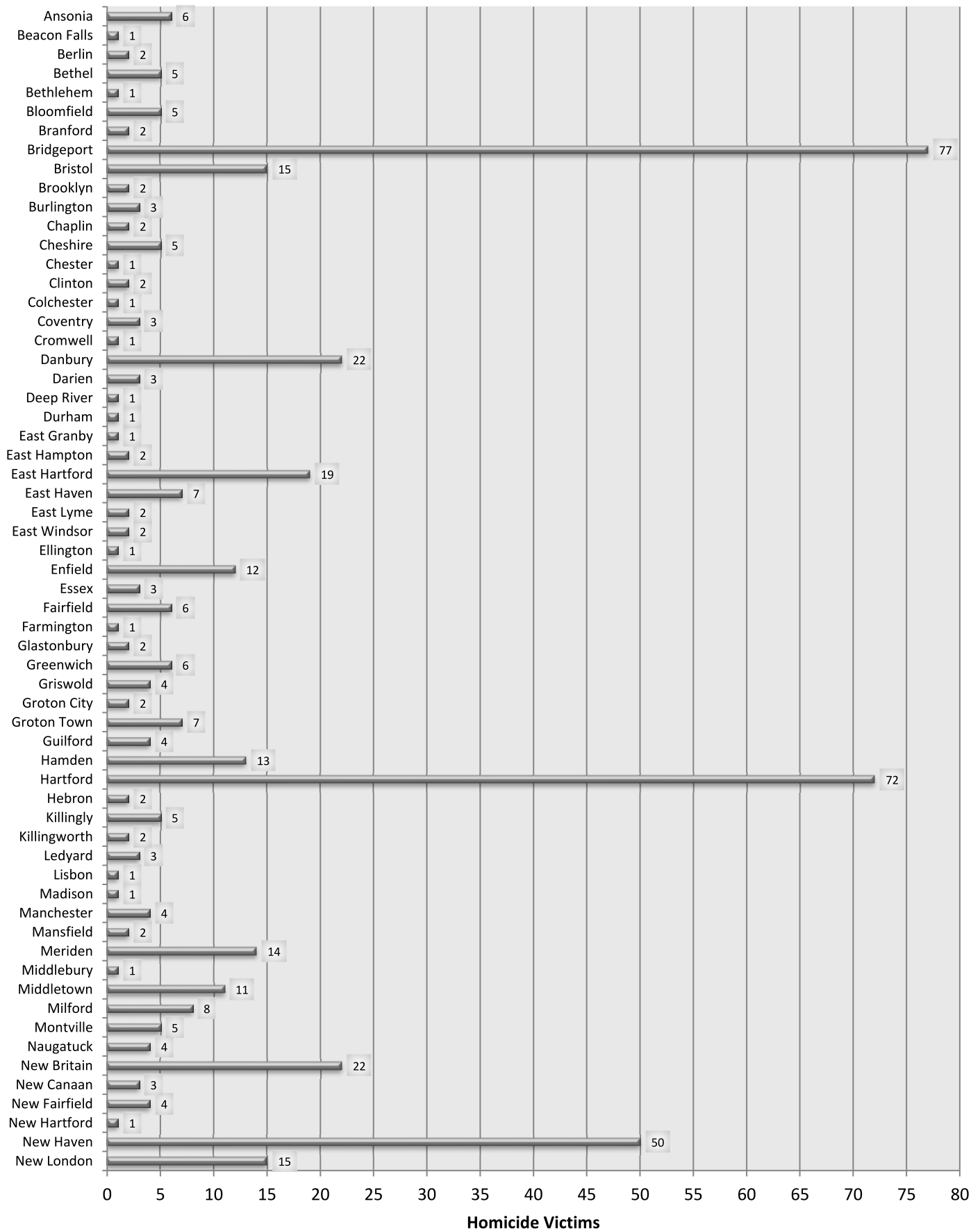
The 24 family violence homicide incidents committed during 2023 occurred in 17 Connecticut municipalities. Six Connecticut municipalities had multiple homicide incidents. Hartford had three, Bridgeport, Danbury, New Britain, New Haven, and Waterbury each had two. Brooklyn's incident was a double murder-suicide.

Family Violence Homicide Incidents by Town 2023



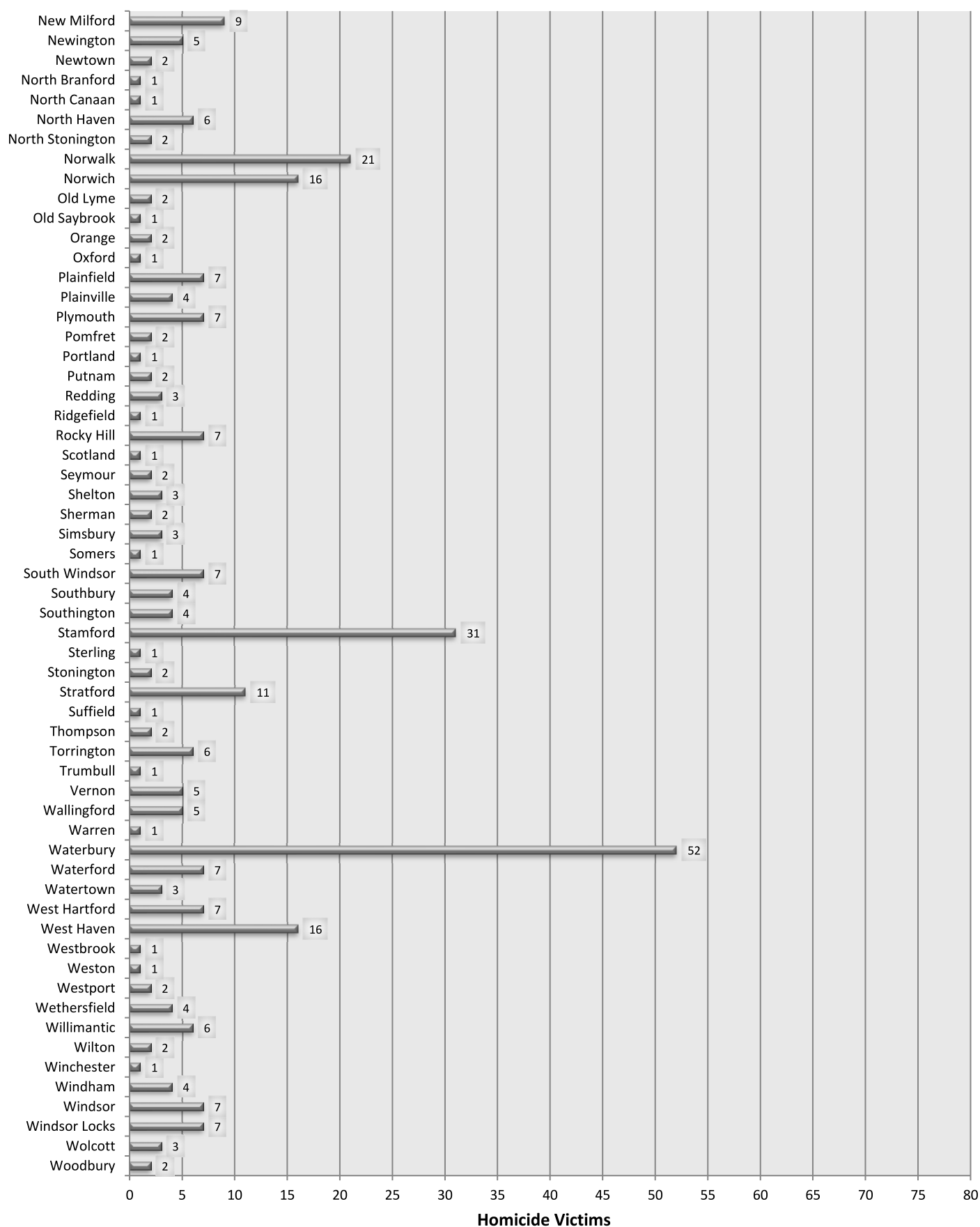
Prior to calendar year 2000, the details of family violence homicides that resulted in no arrest due to the suicide of the offender were not captured. The following table illustrates the total number of family violence victims by town where incident details were captured. With 77 homicide victims, Bridgeport recorded the highest total followed by Hartford (72), Waterbury (52) and New Haven (50). Combined, these four municipalities accounted for 31 percent of Connecticut's family violence homicide victims where incident details were captured (806). A family violence homicide has occurred in 120 municipalities, 71 percent of all Connecticut municipalities.

Family Violence Homicide Victims by Town 1987 - 2023*



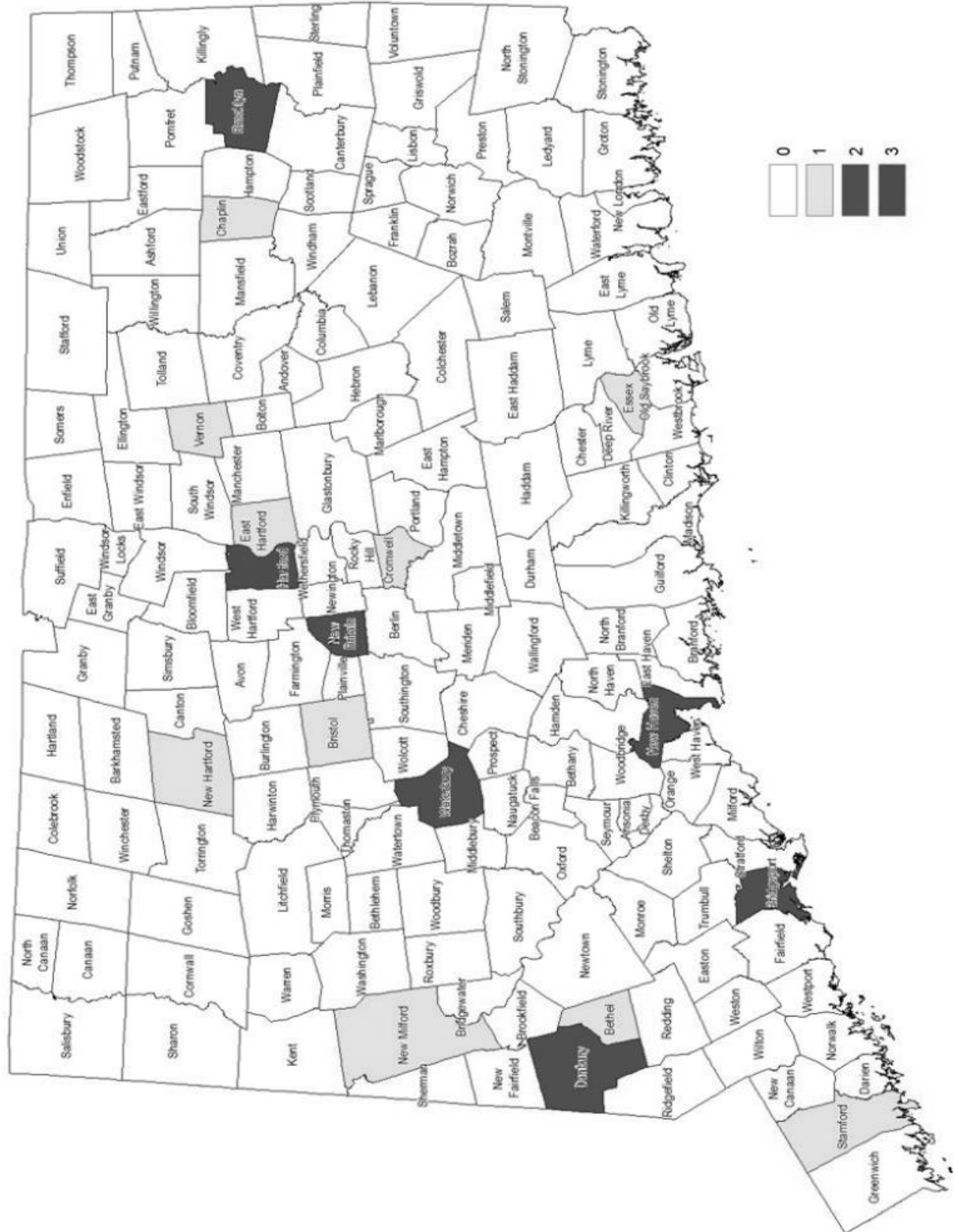
* Prior to calendar year 2000, the details of family violence homicides that resulted in no arrest due to the suicide of the offender were not captured.

Family Violence Homicide Victims by Town 1987 - 2023*

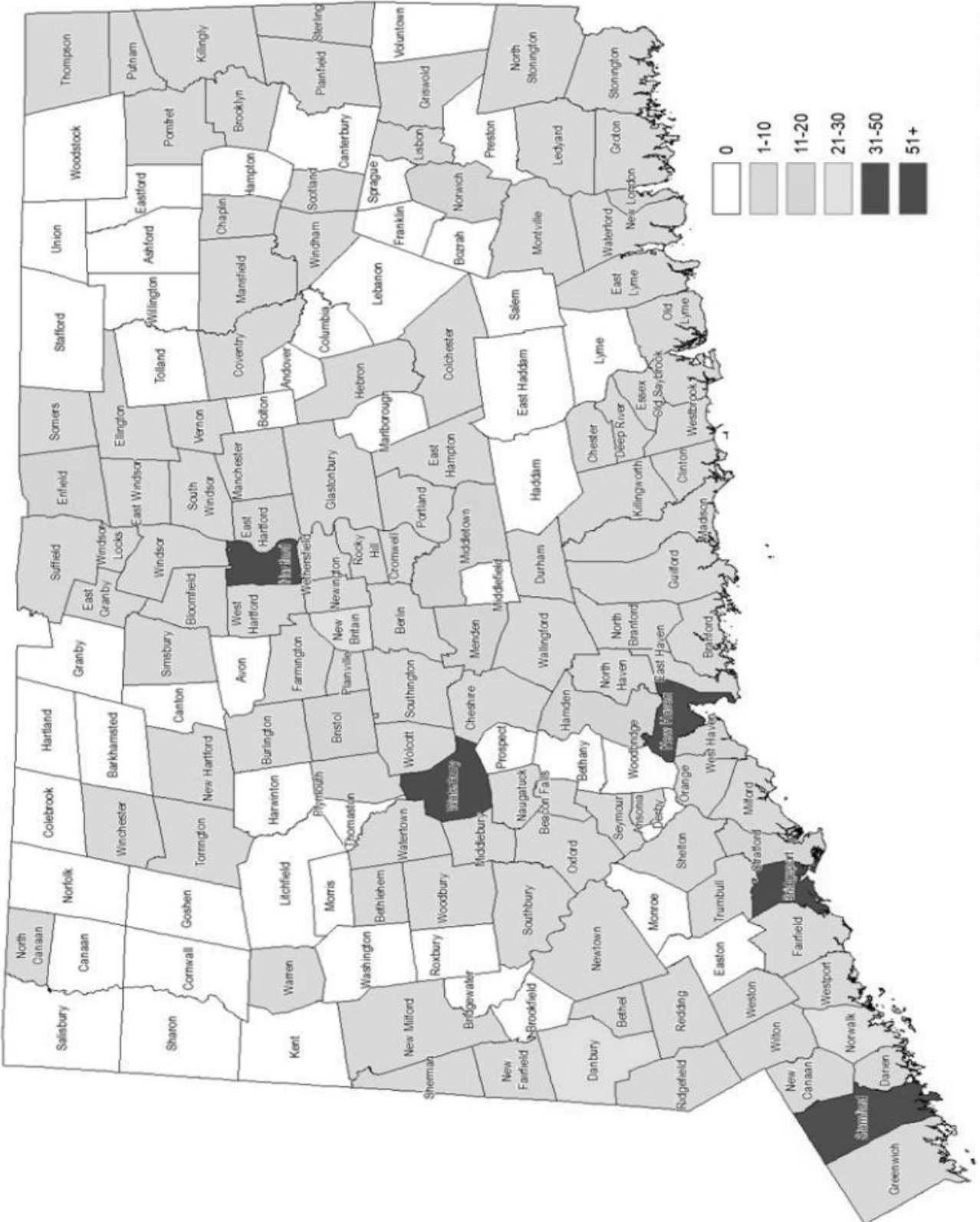


* Prior to calendar year 2000, the details of family violence homicides that resulted in no arrest due to the suicide of the offender were not captured.

Family Violence Homicides by Town, 2023

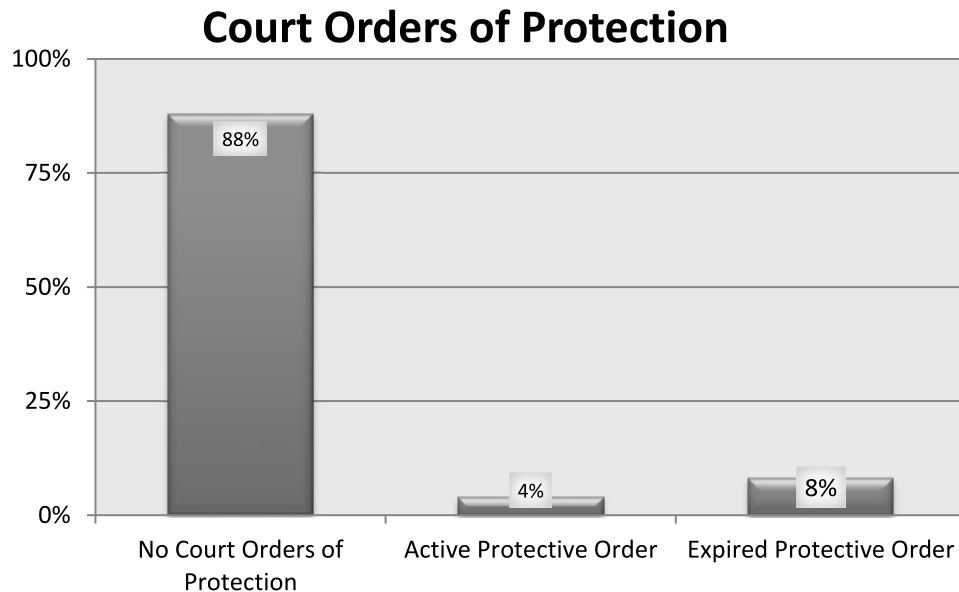


Family Violence Homicides by Town, 1987-2023



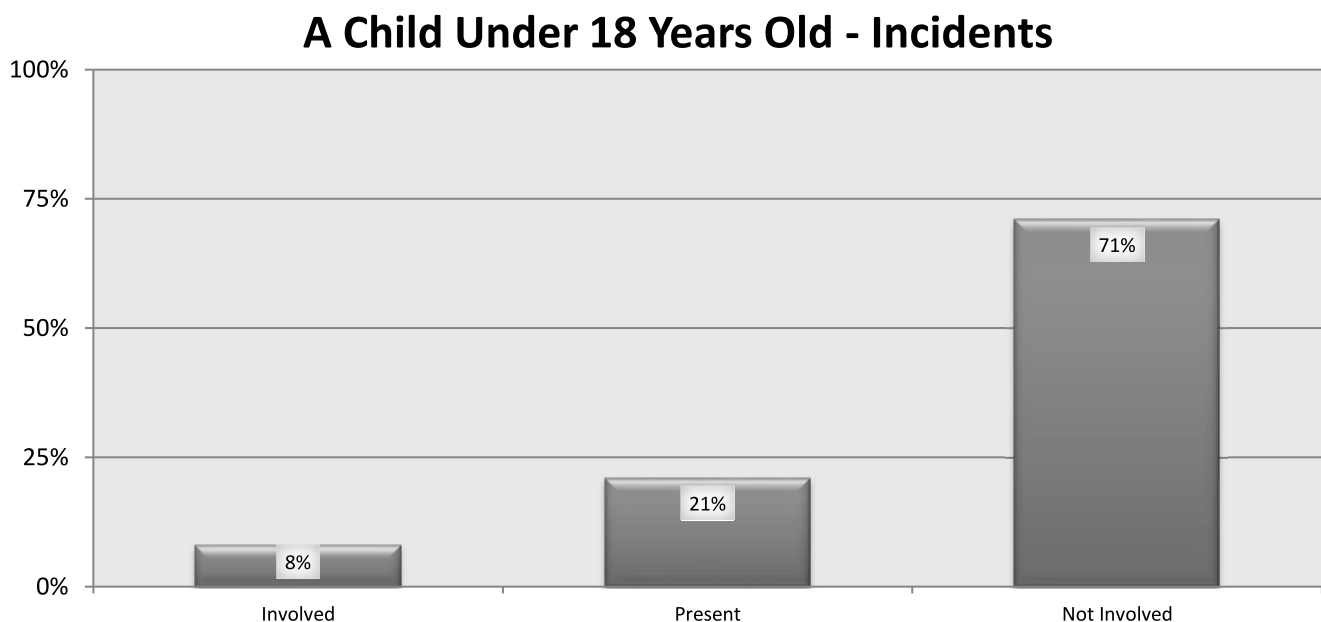
Court Orders of Protection

In 21 family homicide incidents there were no court order of protection, either active or expired (88%). Order types include protective order, ex-parte restraining order, restraining order after hearing, standing criminal protective order, foreign order. In the three homicide incidents with a court order of protection there were only protective orders. In one incident there was an active protective order (4%), in two incidents there were expired protective orders (8%).



A Child Under 18 Years Old

A child under 18 years of age was involved in two family violence homicide incidents (8%). A child under 18 years of age was present in five homicide incidents (21%), and a child under 18 years old was not involved in 17 incidents (71%).

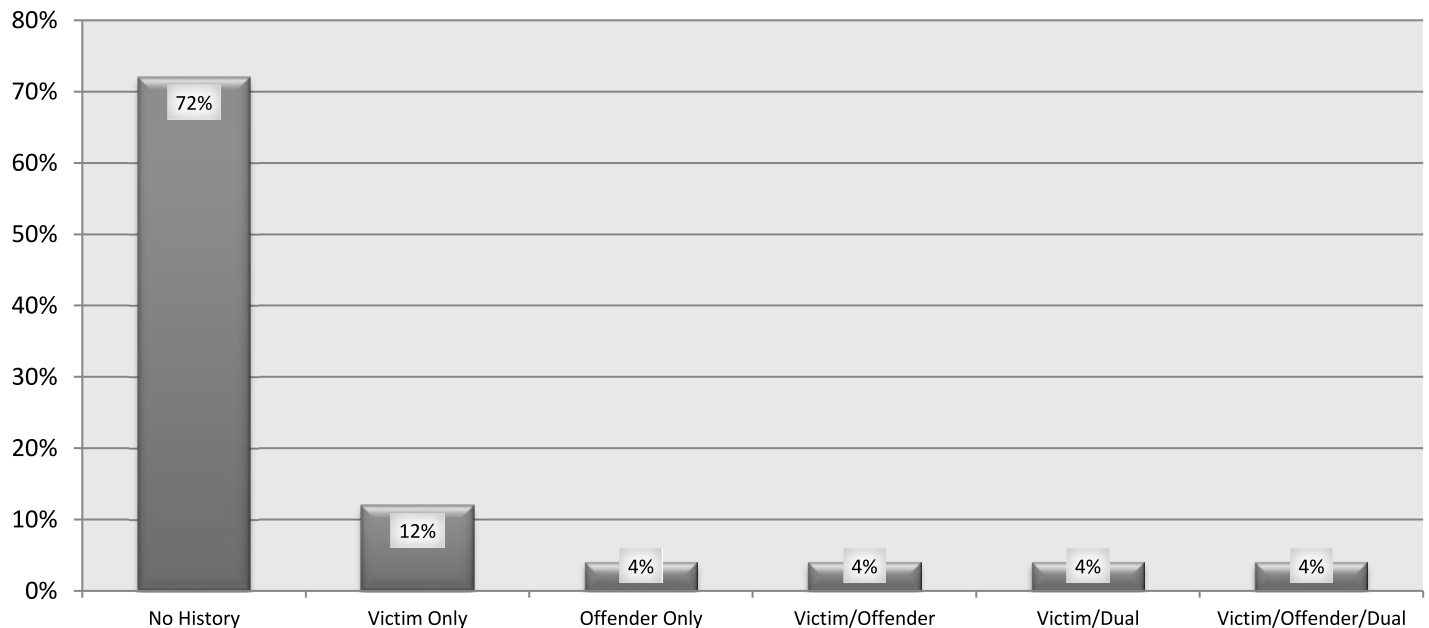


Victim Family Violence History

Eighteen (72%) of the 2023 family violence homicide victims had no history of involvement in a previous family violence arrest incident in the state of Connecticut. Of the other seven victims, three were involved in previous family violence arrest incidents as the victim (12%). One victim was involved as the offender (4%). One was either the victim or the offender (4%), one was involved as the victim or in a dual arrest incident (4%), and one was involved in previous incident as either the victim, offender, or in a dual arrest incident (4%).

2023 Homicide Victim	No Previous Incident	Previous Incident	Previous Incident Status			Involving 2023 Homicide Offender	Incident Offense(s)	Injury	Date Month/Year
			Victim	Offender	Dual Arrest				
Victim 1	X								
Victim 2	X								
Victim 3	X								
Victim 4	X								
Victim 5	X								
Victim 6	X								
Victim 7	X								
Victim 8	X								
Victim 9		Incident 1	X			No	Threatening	No Apparent	Mar-16
		Incident 2	X			No	Assault	No Apparent	Feb-07
Victim 10		Incident 1	X			Yes	Breach of Peace	No Apparent	Oct-10
Victim 11		Incident 1	X			No	Breach-Disorderly Conduct	No Apparent	Apr-17
		Incident 2		X		No	Disorderly Conduct	No Apparent	Dec-04
Victim 12	X								
Victim 13		Incident 1	X			Yes	Assault	Minor	Oct-21
		Incident 2	X			No	Assault	Serious	May-21
		Incident 3	X			Yes	Violation Court Order	No Apparent	Aug-20
		Incident 4			X	Yes	Other	No Apparent	May-20
		Incident 5			X	Yes	Breach-Disorderly Conduct	Minor	May-20
		Incident 6		X		No	Breach-Disorderly Conduct	No Apparent	Mar-20
		Incident 7		X		No	Violation Court Order	No Apparent	Mar-20
Victim 14		Incident 1	X			Yes	Threatening/Breach-Disorderly Conduct	No Apparent	Nov-21
Victim 15	X								
Victim 16		Incident 1	X			Yes	Breach-Disorderly Conduct	No Apparent	Sep-16
		Incident 2			X	No	Assault	Minor	Dec-00
Victim 17	X								
Victim 18	X								
Victim 19	X								
Victim 20		Incident 1		X		No	Violation Court Order/Risk of Injury	No Apparent	Jun-22
		Incident 2		X		No	Assault	Minor	Jul-06
Victim 21	X								
Victim 22	X								
Victim 23	X								
Victim 24	X								
Victim 25	X								

Victim-Family Violence History

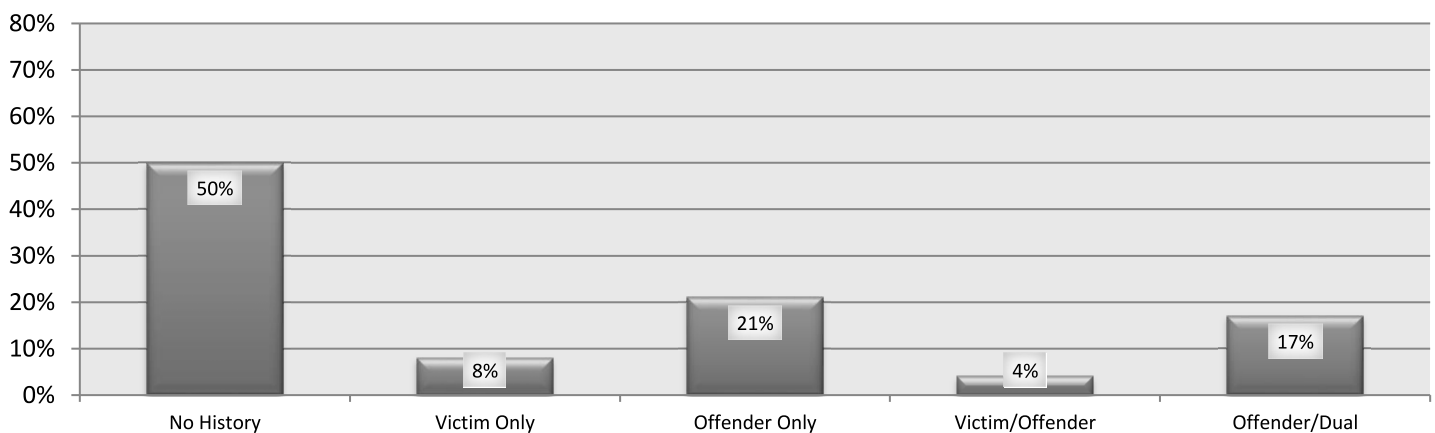


Offender Family Violence History

Twelve (50%) of the 2023 family violence homicide offenders had no history of involvement in a previous family violence arrest incident in the state of Connecticut. Of the other twelve offenders, two were involved in previous family violence arrest incidents as the victim only (8%), five were involved in previous family violence arrest incidents as the offender only (21%), one was involved as either the victim or offender (4%), four were involved as the offender, or in a dual arrest incident (17%).

2023 Homicide Offender	No Previous Incidents	Previous Incidents	Previous Incident Status			Involving 2023 Homicide Victim	Incident Offense(s)	Injury	Date Month/Year
			Victim	Offender	Dual Arrest				
Offender 1	X								
Offender 2	X								
Offender 3	X								
Offender 4	X								
Offender 5	X								
Offender 6	X								
Offender 7	Incident 1			X		No	Breach-Disorderly Conduct	No Apparent	Oct-22
	Incident 2			X		No	Assault,Threatening,Breach-Disorderly Conduct,Risk of Injury	Minor	Apr-21
	Incident 3			X		No	Breach-Disorderly Conduct	No Apparent	Aug-20
Offender 8	X								
Offender 9	Incident 1			X		Yes	Breach of Peace	No Apparent	Oct-10
Offender 10	Incident 1		X			No	Breach-Disorderly Conduct	Minor	Apr-23
Offender 11	X								
Offender 12	Incident 1			X		Yes	Assault	Minor	Oct-21
	Incident 2			X		Yes	Violation Court Order	No Apparent	Aug-20
	Incident 3			X		No	Breach-Disorderly Conduct	No Apparent	Jul-20
	Incident 4				X	Yes	Other	No Apparent	May-20
	Incident 5				X	Yes	Breach-Disorderly Conduct	Minor	May-20
	Incident 6				X	No	Violation Court Order/Breach-Disorderly Conduct	No Apparent	Jun-18
Offender 13	Incident 1			X		Yes	Threatening/Breach-Disorderly Conduct	No Apparent	Nov-21
	Incident 2			X		No	Violation Court Order	No Apparent	May-19
	Incident 3			X		No	Disorderly Conduct	Minor	May-99
	Incident 4				X	No	Assault	Minor	Aug-96
	Incident 5			X		No	Assault	Minor	May-88
Offender 14	Incident 1				X	No	Breach of Peace	No Apparent	Jul-11
	Incident 2			X		No	Assault	Minor	Apr-08
	Incident 3			X		No	Other/Violation Court Order	No Apparent	Jun-07
	Incident 4			X		No	Assault	No Apparent	Nov-06
	Incident 5			X		No	Assault	No Apparent	May-05
Offender 15	Incident 1			X		Yes	Breach-Disorderly Conduct	No Apparent	Sep-16
Offender 16	Incident 1		X			No	Violation Court Order	Minor	Dec-16
	Incident 2		X			No	Assault	No Apparent	Dec-16
Offender 17	Incident 1			X		No	Assault	Minor	Aug-06
	Incident 2			X		No	Other/Violation Court Order	No Apparent	Aug-04
Offender 18	X								
Offender 19	X								
Offender 20	X								
Offender 21	Incident 1				X	No	Assault	Minor	Sep-94
	Incident 2			X		No	Assault	Minor	Jul-94
Offender 22	X								
Offender 23	Incident 1			X		No	Breach-Disorderly Conduct	Minor	Dec-23
	Incident 2			X		No	Breach-Disorderly Conduct	No Apparent	Dec-23
Offender 24	Incident 1		X			No	Breach-Disorderly Conduct	No Apparent	Dec-19
	Incident 2			X		No	Other/Violation Court Order	No Apparent	Mar-06
	Incident 3			X		No	Assault	Minor	Feb-06
	Incident 4			X		No	Breach of Peace	No Apparent	Jul-05

Offender-Family Violence History



2023 Family Violence Homicide Circumstances

1. **01/31/23 Bethel P.D.** Victim: Female, 52 Relationship: Spouse

Circumstances: Responding to a complaint regarding yelling, police found the victim shot once in the chest and once in the head by her estranged husband who then turned his gun upon himself. The victim was pronounced dead at the residence. Two weeks prior to the murder-suicide, the victim filed for ex-parte restraining order and reported being verbally and emotionally abused by her husband and told police the suspect repeatedly threatened her life.

Suspect Suicide: Male, 58

2. **02/14/23 CSP-Brooklyn** Victim: Female, 33 Relationship: Child in Common

Circumstances: Responding to a report of a suspicious incident where neighbors heard rounds of gunfire, police and medics found the victim and her son dead of gunshot wounds. The victim had been shot in the head, neck, and torso. The victim's son died of a gunshot wound to the head. The offender, father of the son, died of a self-inflicted gunshot wound.

Suspect Suicide: Male, 32

3. **02/14/23 CSP-Brooklyn** Victim: Male, 3 Relationship: Other relative *not* residing in home

Circumstances: Responding to a report of a suspicious incident where neighbors heard rounds of gunfire, police and medics found the victim and his mother dead of gunshot wounds. The victim had been shot in the head. The victim's mother died of gunshot wounds to the head, neck, and torso. The offender, father of the victim, died of a self-inflicted gunshot wound.

Suspect Suicide: Male, 32

4. **02/20/23 Bridgeport P.D.** Victim: Male, 68 Relationship: Other relative residing in home

Circumstances: An argument between the victim and suspect at their apartment turned violent and caused the victim's death three days later. According to the suspect's mother the fight between her son and her father happened when the suspect punched the victim in the jaw because the victim wouldn't buy marijuana for the suspect. The victim went to the hospital the next day because his jaw was swollen. When he returned home later, his daughter noticed he began vomiting and sleeping for extended periods. She called 911 after finding her father unresponsive on the couch. Medics pronounced him dead on scene. The victim's death was ruled a homicide caused by complications from blunt impact injury to the head with bleeding in the brain.

Suspect Arrested: Male, 23

5. **03/06/23 Bridgeport P.D.** Victim: Female, 23 Relationship: Child in Common

Circumstances: The suspect was arrested in Ohio nearly two weeks after he fatally shot the victim in the presence of her baby in her condominium. A neighbor described hearing the victim and offender argue before in several loud disputes. Police had been called out to the residence several times before for domestic incidents involving the couple, the most recent less than two weeks prior to the homicide incident.

Suspect Arrested: Male, 41

6. 03/07/23 Waterbury P.D. Victim: Female, 45 Relationship: Spouse

Circumstances: The offender shot and killed his estranged wife and shot and wounded their son. Police said the offender had a violent criminal record, including a felony gun charge, and should not have been in possession of a firearm. Six hours after the homicide Virginia state police initiated a traffic stop on the offender's vehicle. The Virginia officers attempted to speak with the offender, but as they approached the vehicle, they heard a single gunshot from inside the vehicle. The offender shot himself and died of from injuries in an apparent suicide; a firearm was recovered from inside the vehicle.

Suspect Suicide: Male, 44

7. 03/19/23 Stamford P.D. Victim: Male, 21 Relationship: Dating

Circumstances: The body of the victim was found in the woods at a public park by a woman walking her dogs. The victim was found naked from the waist down with multiple bruises and scratches on his body. Investigators saw that several pieces of the victim's clothing were scattered throughout the crime scene. The victim died by compression of the neck. At the time, the victim had been reported missing by his family, and police were investigating the disappearance when his body was found. Police embarked on a three-and-a-half-month-long investigation which culminated with a significant amount of video and forensic evidence. The investigation determined that a physical altercation took place resulting in the offender killing the victim while the two were in the park during the early morning hours.

Suspect Arrested: Male, 21

8. 04/10/23 Waterbury P.D. Victim: Male, 67 Relationship: Other relative *not* residing in home

Circumstances: The offender attacked the victim, his father, with a wooden stick hitting him multiple times in the chest and back. The offender knew the victim had a serious heart condition and had a pacemaker. Police report that after the victim fell to the ground, the offender yelled at the victim and told him to die. The victim died of cardiac arrest at the scene. Relatives reported the offender has a drinking problem and was drunk at the time of the incident. The offender has been diagnosed with schizophrenia and bipolar disorder.

Suspect Arrested: Male, 42

9. 04/16/23 Hartford P.D. Victim: Female, 57 Relationship: Dating

Circumstances: The offender drove to the police station, approached the front desk, and told officers he had just stabbed the victim, and she was in a vehicle parked in front of the police department. Officers found the victim unresponsive, covered in blood. The victim was stabbed more than 25 times in her chest, head, face, and arms. A knife was found in the car's center console. The offender found out the victim was having an affair and was planning to kill the victim for several days. The offender told officers that he hid the knife in his pants pocket and drove the victim to get food. After they ate, the offender drove to a secluded parking lot and stabbed the victim. The offender told officers that he waited for the victim to die before driving to the police department. It was revealed that the offender took a photo of the victim after the fatal stabbing and sent the photo to the victim's new boyfriend.

Suspect Arrested: Male, 52

10. 05/10/23 CSP-Chaplin

Victim: Female, 38

Relationship: Spouse

Circumstances: While investigating a single occupant fatal motor vehicle accident, it was revealed the deceased operator, and the homicide victim were reported missing by family members. The victim's body was discovered in a hotel room. The cause of death was compression of neck.

Suspect Deceased: Male, 38

11. 06/05/23 New Milford P.D.

Victim: Female, 56

Relationship: Other relative residing in home

Circumstances: Police received a call from the offender who said he had just killed his mother in a river at a public park. The offender stayed on the phone with officers for several minutes and described the events that took place before the killing and gave police his exact location. The offender stated he had been having a "hard time for the past couple of weeks" and he has been "feeling tormented by demons," adding that he has been in mental health treatment. The offender also revealed he was "sacrificing his mother to make the demons stop." The offender told police he and the victim walked the river trail at the park several times a week. On their final walk the offender encouraged the victim to get close to the water, pushed her in, and "held her underwater for approximately 10 minutes until she stopped moving."

Suspect Arrested: Male, 34

12. 06/17/23 East Hartford P.D.

Victim: Female, 51

Relationship: Spouse

Circumstances: The victim was found dead after police were sent to conduct a welfare check at the victim's home. The victim died from stab wounds to her head, neck, torso, and extremities. Police said the woman was killed in an act of "extreme physical violence." Through several security cameras, investigators tracked a white van showing signs of what appeared to be a "blood-like substance" from the area near the crime scene to the area of the suspect's home. After DNA testing, officials say that blood-like substance was consistent with DNA found at the scene of the crime, helping lead to the arrest of the victim's estranged husband.

Suspect Arrested: Male, 57

13. 07/17/23 Vernon P.D.

Victim: Female, 22

Relationship: Child in Common

Circumstances: Responding to a welfare check, police found the victim dead in her apartment. The offender told police that he strangled the victim, the mother of his child, while the two were being intimate because he was angry with her. The victim had previously filed two restraining orders against the offender because the offender beat her, was a drug addict, and that she was scared for her and her son. Both orders were dismissed because the victim did not show up for the court dates. The offender had previously been charged with violating a protective order against the victim. The offender told police he had been dating the victim for six years and had been staying at her apartment after he recently got out of jail. The offender also told police he stopped taking his psych medications a month before the murder because he didn't like the side-effects.

Suspect Arrested: Male, 23

14. 07/17/23 Hartford P.D.

Victim: Female, 64

Relationship: Dating

Circumstances: Responding to a 911 call regarding domestic violence incident police found a man suffering from injuries to his head and he reported his mother had been shot. The man who suffered an injury to his head was pistol-whipped by the suspect during the incident. After entering the home, officers located the male suspect with a shotgun within reach and secured the suspect. The victim was located dead in the home with multiple gunshot wounds.

Suspect Arrested: Male, 63

15. 07/24/23 Hartford P.D.

Victim: Female, 24

Relationship: Dating

Circumstances: The victim's family went to the shared apartment for a well-being check and found the victim and offender suffering from gunshot wounds. They called 911 and reported two gunshot victims. Both were declared dead at the scene. The victim's cause of death was ruled as gunshot wounds to the neck, torso, and extremities. The suspect's cause of death was listed as a gunshot wound to the head, with the manner of death ruled a suicide.

Suspect Suicide: Male, 35

16. 08/19/23 New Haven P.D.

Victim: Female, 54

Relationship: Child in Common

Circumstances: Police were called to the victim's house where the victim told them about a "physical altercation with her children's father earlier in the evening." Police looked for the man but did not find him and were unsuccessful in locating the gun the suspect had allegedly stolen. Police returned to the residence in response to reports of gunfire and found the victim and suspect lying on the street, bleeding from gunshot wounds that eventually killed them both. The victim was rushed to the hospital in critical condition where she died multiple days later. Police said the incident wasn't an attempted murder-suicide, rather a family member trying to protect the victim shot the suspect.

Suspect Deceased: Male, 54

17. 09/11/23 CSP-Cromwell

Victim: Female, 2

Relationship: Other relative residing in home

Circumstances: The victim was found in the Connecticut River hours after the suspect was involved in a motor vehicle accident. The suspect was located walking along the highway wearing only undergarments and stated that she and her daughter had swam in the river before directing officers to look for her daughter in the water. First responders enlisted the help of firefighter marine teams to search the river for the child. The victim was found by the firefighter marine team in a rocky part of the riverbank in the water. During the investigation, the suspect's family and coworkers told authorities that the suspect had been acting erratically in the days leading up to the incident and that the suspect's her mother and another person had tried to separate the suspect from her daughter the day before her death but had been unsuccessful.

Suspect Arrested: Female, 24

18. 10/14/23 CSP-New Hartford

Victim: Female, 48

Relationship: Spouse

Circumstances: Responding to a 911 call reporting screaming and gunshots, police found the victim dead in the couple's driveway from a gunshot wound to the head. The victim's body was covered with a drop cloth. The suspect was seen outside the home but returned inside after seeing officers. In the interest of safety officers temporarily disengaged from the residence. A short time later officers approached again and found the suspect apparently suffering from a medical issue. The suspect had blood on his clothing. The suspect was taken to the hospital for evaluation and treatment. Officers checking the interior of the residence found conditions inside the house consistent with violent disturbance including blood on the walls and the floor. Police also found a rifle and a revolver inside the home. The revolver had a blood-like substance on it.

Suspect Arrested: Male, 50

19. 10/27/23 Danbury P.D.

Victim: Female, 21

Relationship: Dating

Circumstances: While investigating a verbal altercation, police saw the offender with a survival-type knife in his hand standing over the victim lying on the road. The victim had been stabbed several times. As the police exited their vehicle to render aid, the offender proceeded to stab himself in the chest and fell to the ground. The victim and offender were treated at the scene before being taken to the hospital where they were both pronounced dead. The victim and offender lived together and appeared to be in a failing relationship and were separating.

Suspect Suicide: Male, 28

20. 10/28/23 CSP-Essex

Victim: Male, 36

Relationship: Other relative *not* residing in home

Circumstances: The offender told police that he stabbed the victim to stop him from seriously hurting or killing the victim's girlfriend. The offender called 911 to report the stabbing. In the 911 call the offender said the victim and the victim's girlfriend had been fighting, which resulted in him stabbing the victim in the back several times. The girlfriend of the victim told police that she was hurt during the assault and was hospitalized with non-life-threatening injuries. She reported that her 9-year-old daughter was in the bedroom asleep during the incident. It was reported the victim hadn't been taking prescribed medication for bipolar disorder and schizophrenia. The victim and his girlfriend had reportedly broken up, and the girlfriend said the victim wanted to come get his belongings, but she said no because her child was home. That's when the victim came inside the house unannounced. A fight broke out between the two, and the offender, his 18-year-old girlfriend tried to intervene. Police were told that the fight escalated, and that's when the offender allegedly jumped in and stabbed the victim multiple times. It was reported the victim had previously threatened to kill all three of them. He has also been very aggressive and combative towards family members in the past. The victim had a criminal history including charges of strangulation, risk of injury to a child and more.

Suspect Arrested: Male, 18

21. 11/20/23 Danbury P.D.

Victim: Female, 21

Relationship: Child in Common

Circumstances: While responding to a distress call described as a crisis intervention, police dispatch updated the report as a possible suicide. Fire Department and EMS were on the scene when the police officers arrived and had already entered the apartment and found the victim and offender dead. The couple's one-year old son, who did not appear to be injured, also was present. The child was transported to the hospital for evaluation and an examination showed no apparent injuries. It was concluded that the offender stabbed the victim in the head and neck with a large kitchen knife before taking his own life with the same knife.

Suspect Suicide: Male, 29

22. 12/01/23 New Britain P.D.

Victim: Female, 27

Relationship: Dating

Circumstances: Members of the victim's family, including her 10-year-old daughter, discovered the victim's body inside her apartment. The victim was shot five times and was pronounced dead at the scene. The victim's 10-year-old daughter told detectives her mother argued with the offender before she went to school, and said her mother told the offender to get his stuff and leave. The offender reportedly left the apartment and the victim's daughter got on the bus to go to school. When the victim's daughter returned from school, she tried to get in through the front door, but it was locked. She went through the back door and found her mother unresponsive on the floor. Investigators believe the offender returned to the apartment and shot the victim not long after her daughter left for school. Police tracked the offender through his cell phone to a location in Pennsylvania. Local police found him at a hotel where they said he was staying with another woman who he shares children with. The offender was extradited back to Connecticut. The family said the victim was pregnant at the time of her death with the offender's child. The offender has a lengthy, multi-state criminal past that includes charges like first-degree assault, conspiracy for robbery, and possession of a firearm.

Suspect Arrested: Male, 46

23. 12/14/23 New Haven P.D.

Victim: Female, 52

Relationship: Spouse

Circumstances: Police responded to a report of a husband and wife found unresponsive in their home. Firefighters attempted to render aid to the couple, but both were pronounced dead on the scene. The victim died from a gunshot wound to the torso, the offender died of a self-inflicted gunshot wound to the head.

Suspect Suicide: Male, 62

24. 12/25/23 Bristol P.D.

Victim: Female, 83

Relationship: Other relative residing in home

Circumstances: Police found the victim dead in a bedroom, beaten to death with head and neck injuries, multiple broken ribs and cuts or injuries to her liver, spleen, lungs, heart, and knee. When the suspect who lived with the victim was questioned by the police, he implied someone broke into their home when he wasn't there. Officers noticed his left hand was swollen and had cut marks on his knuckles. Police investigation found a bloody earring back and iPhone charger, along with smeared blood-stained blinds containing the victim's blood and the suspect's DNA. The suspect told detectives he left the home on the evening of the homicide, hung out with a friend, then spent the night in a local park, even leaving his phone overnight. Police said surveillance cameras showed a different story: that the suspect didn't sleep in the park, instead he stashed his phone as a cover up.

Suspect Arrested: Male, 38

25. 12/30/23 New Britain P.D.

Victim: Female, 44

Relationship: Dating

Circumstances: An argument about missing shoes led to the offender shooting and killing the victim. The offender also shot the victim's mother and brother, who was paralyzed before the shooting. Reportedly the offender was high on drugs at the time and couldn't find a pair of shoes, so he went into the victim's brother's room and shot him, then shot the victim's mother, then shot the victim in front of her mother. The victim's mother hopped out of a window to go and get help after she got shot. A witness told police that over the last week, the offender had been arguing with the victim over random things, and the night of the crime, had started an argument over her doing his laundry. The victim and offender had been dating on and off for about 10 years.

Suspect Arrested: Male, 44

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